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**Yanagida et al.**

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(54) **VEHICLE BRAKE SYSTEM**

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**B60T 7/04** (2006.01)  
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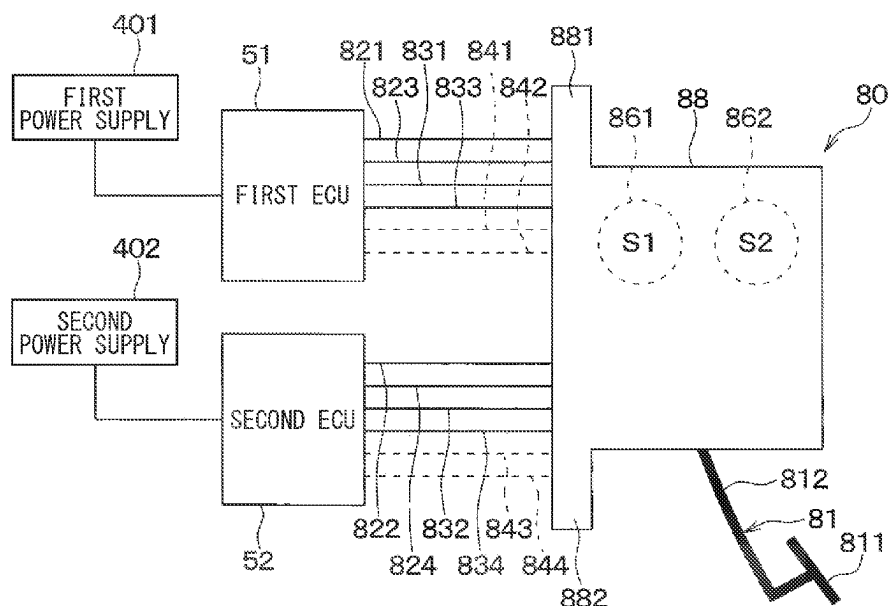
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A vehicle brake system includes a vehicle brake device and a hydraulic pressure generation unit. The vehicle brake device includes: a brake pedal that has a pedal portion, and a lever portion rotating about a rotation axis in response to the pedal portion being operated; a stroke sensor that outputs a signal based on a stroke amount of the brake pedal; a housing that rotatably supports the lever portion; and a reaction force generation portion that generates a reaction force applied on the lever portion based on the stroke amount. The hydraulic pressure generation unit generates a hydraulic pressure for braking a vehicle.

**2 Claims, 22 Drawing Sheets**



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*B60T 11/10* (2006.01)  
*B60T 13/68* (2006.01)  
*B60T 17/22* (2006.01)
- (52) **U.S. Cl.**  
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(2013.01); *B60T 2270/402* (2013.01); *B60T*  
*2270/413* (2013.01)
- (58) **Field of Classification Search**  
CPC ..... B60T 11/103; B60T 2270/402; B60T  
2270/413; B60T 13/662; B60T 2220/04  
See application file for complete search history.

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**FIG. 1**

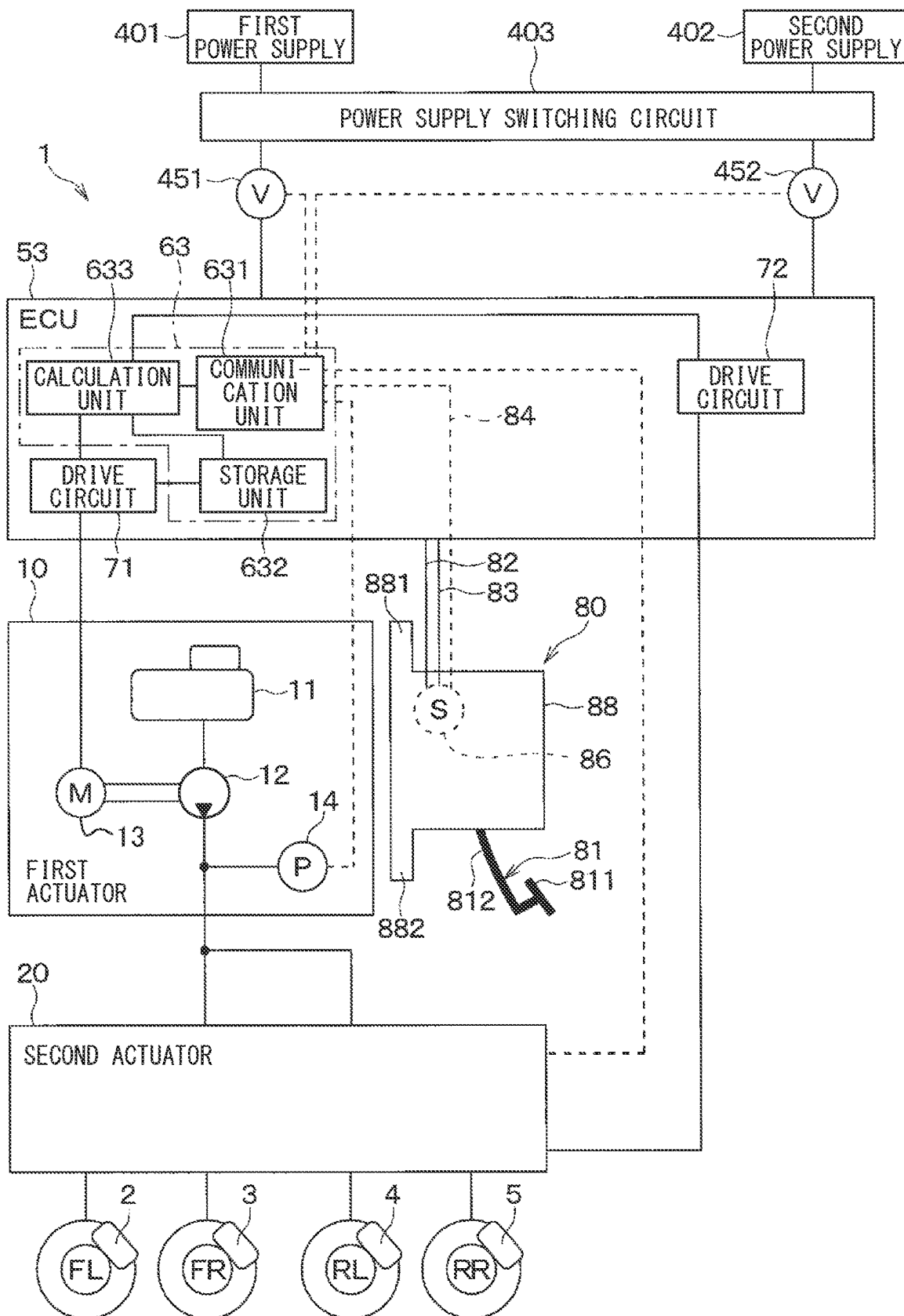


FIG. 2

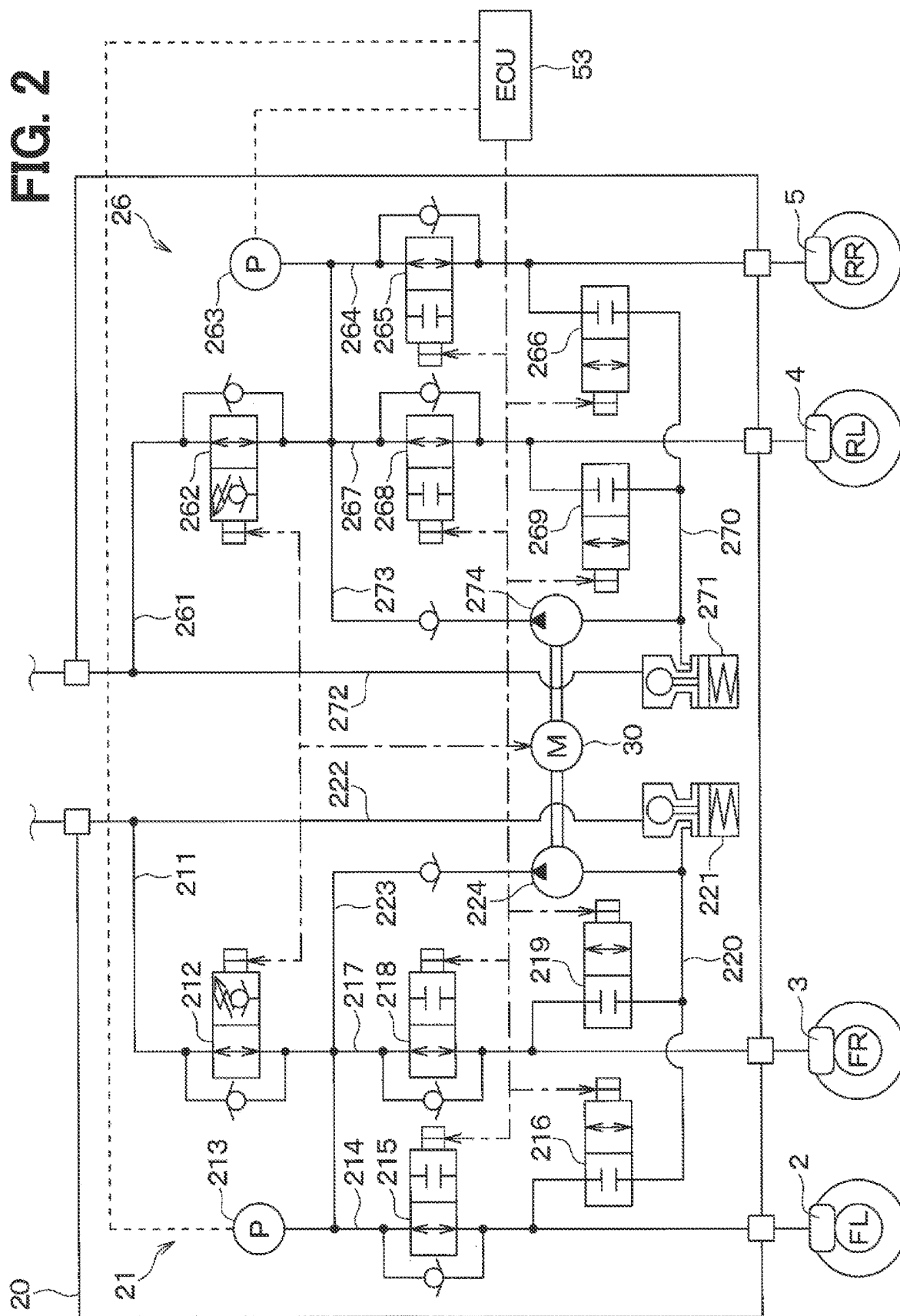
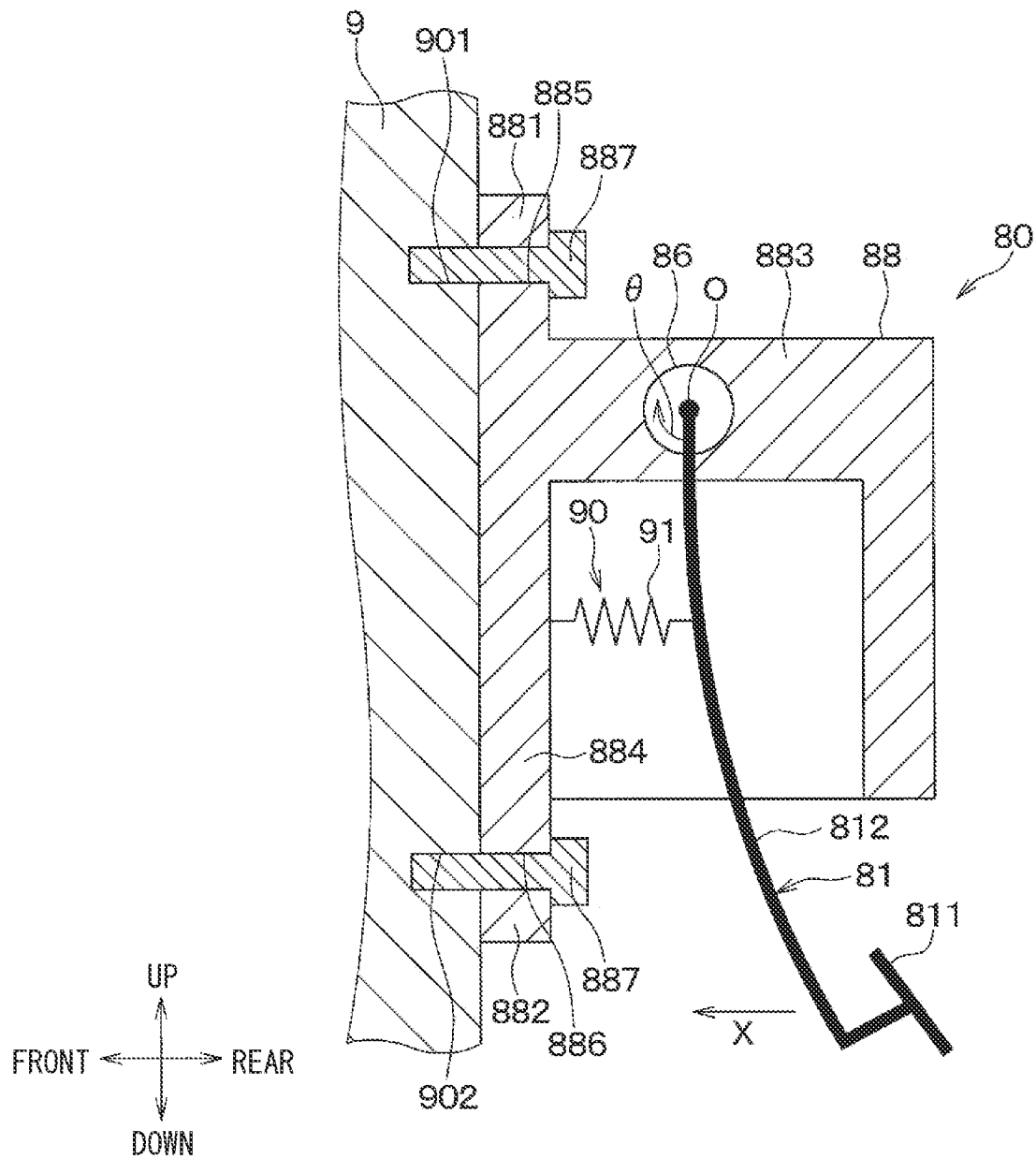
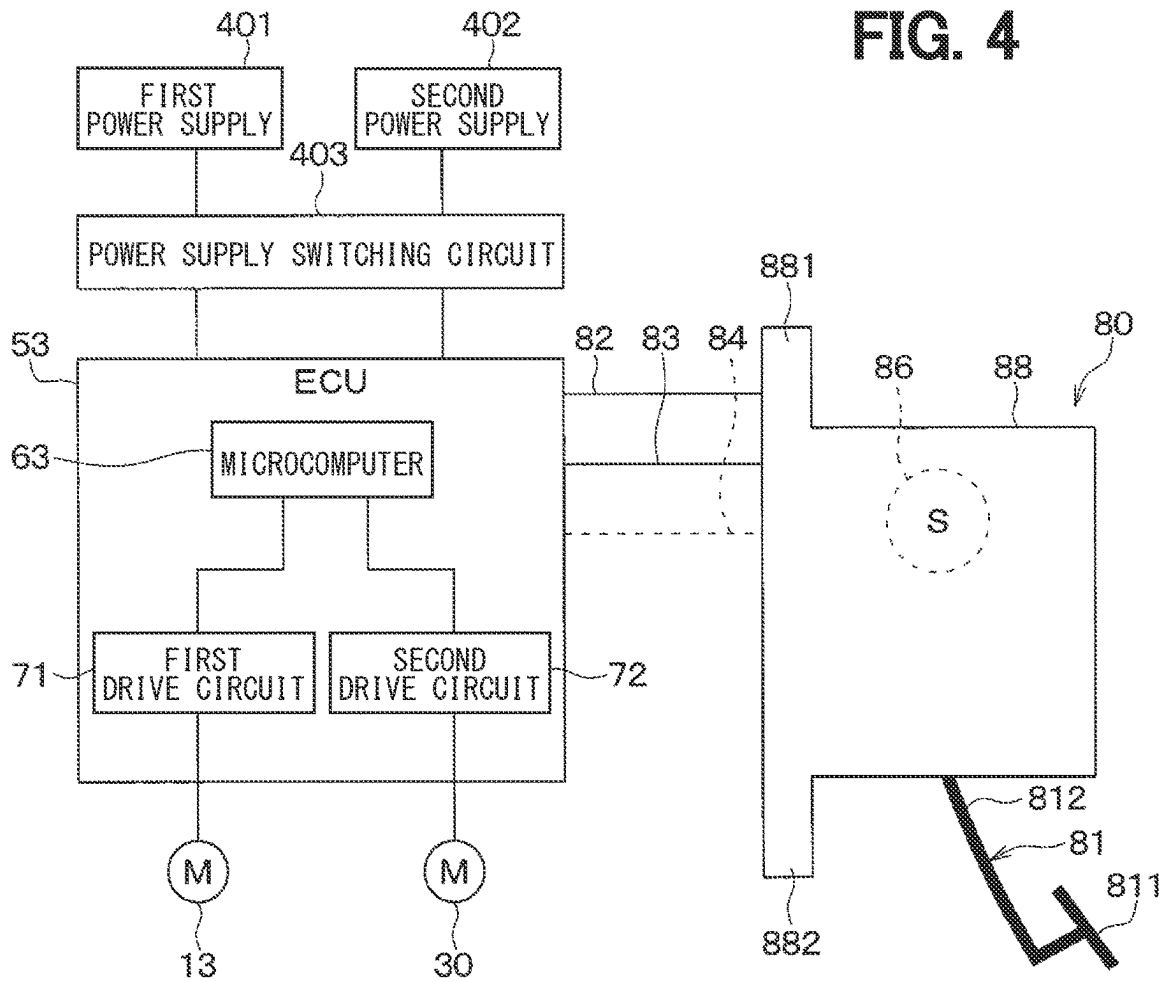
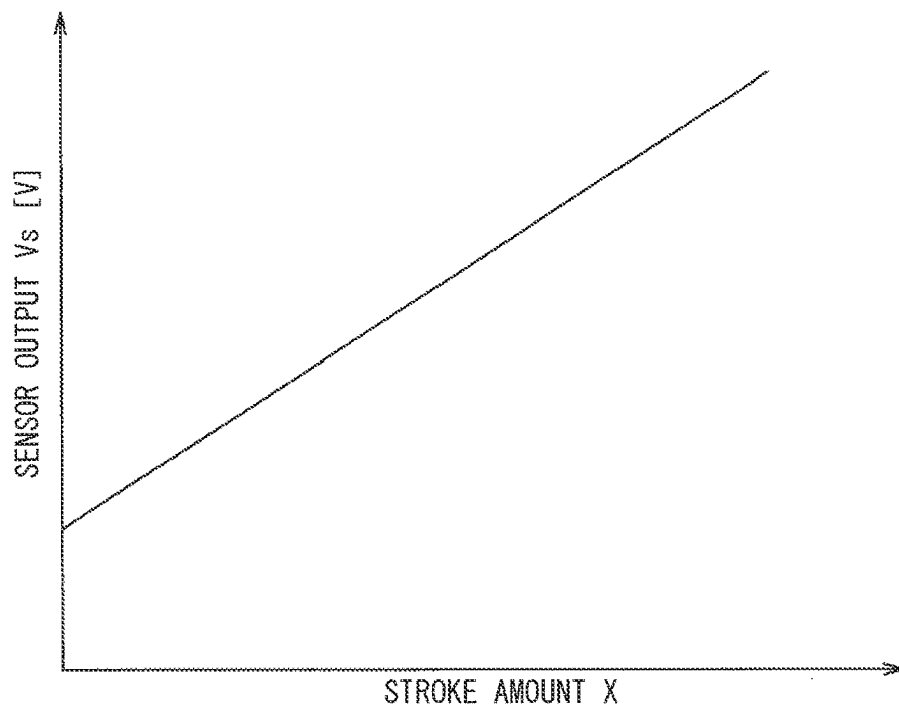
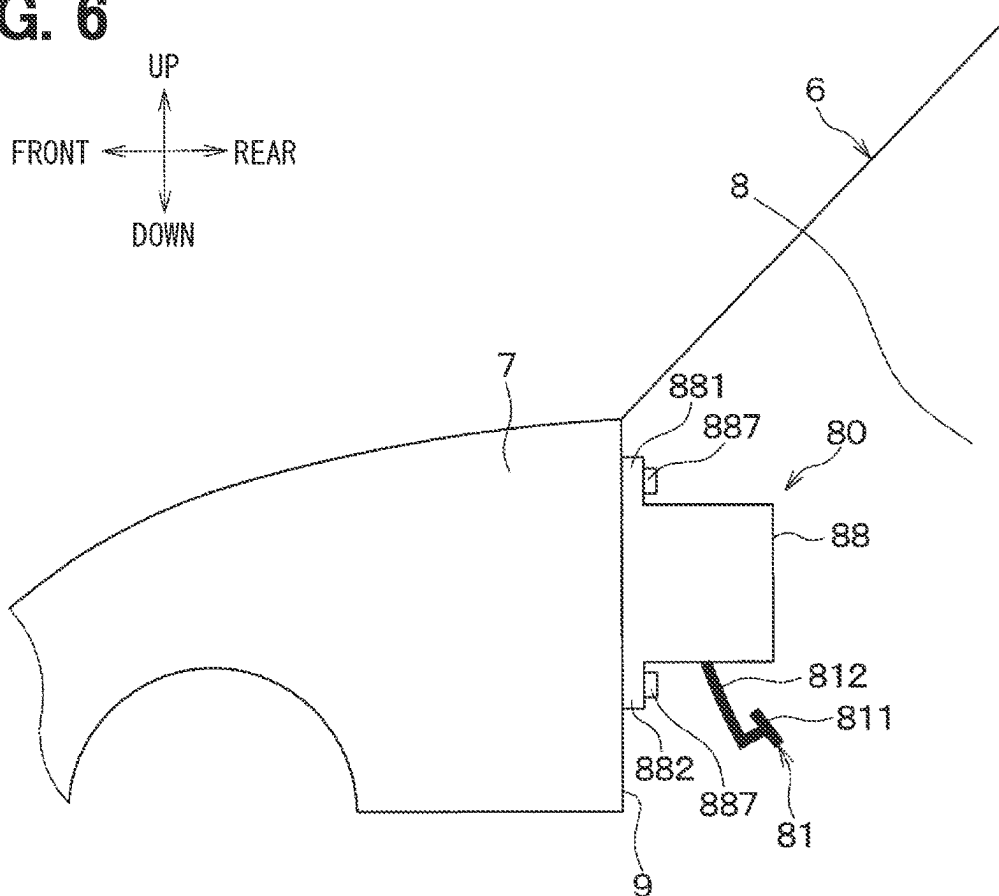


FIG. 3

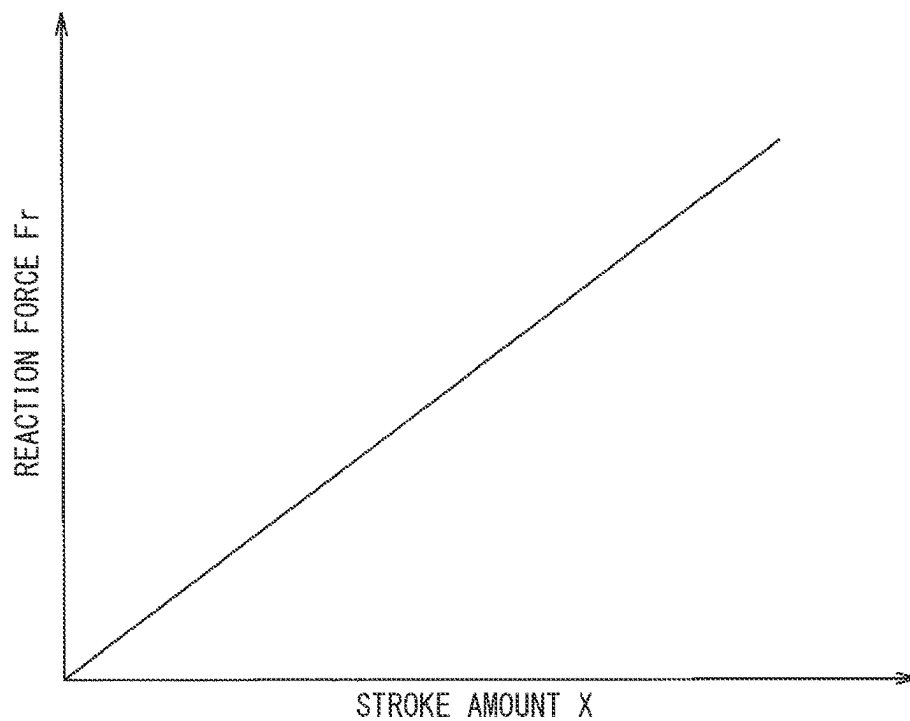


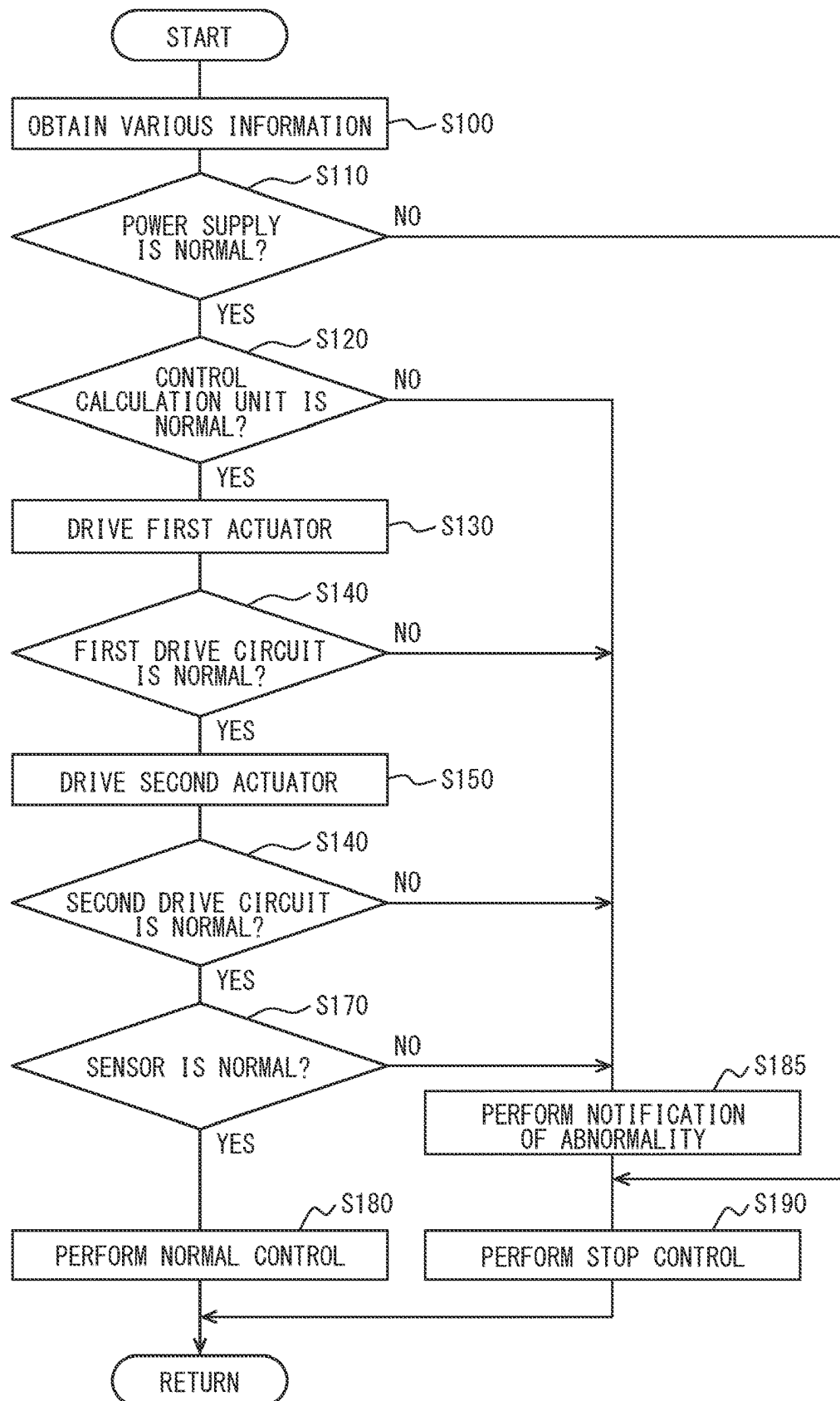
**FIG. 4****FIG. 5**

**FIG. 6**



**FIG. 7**



**FIG. 8**



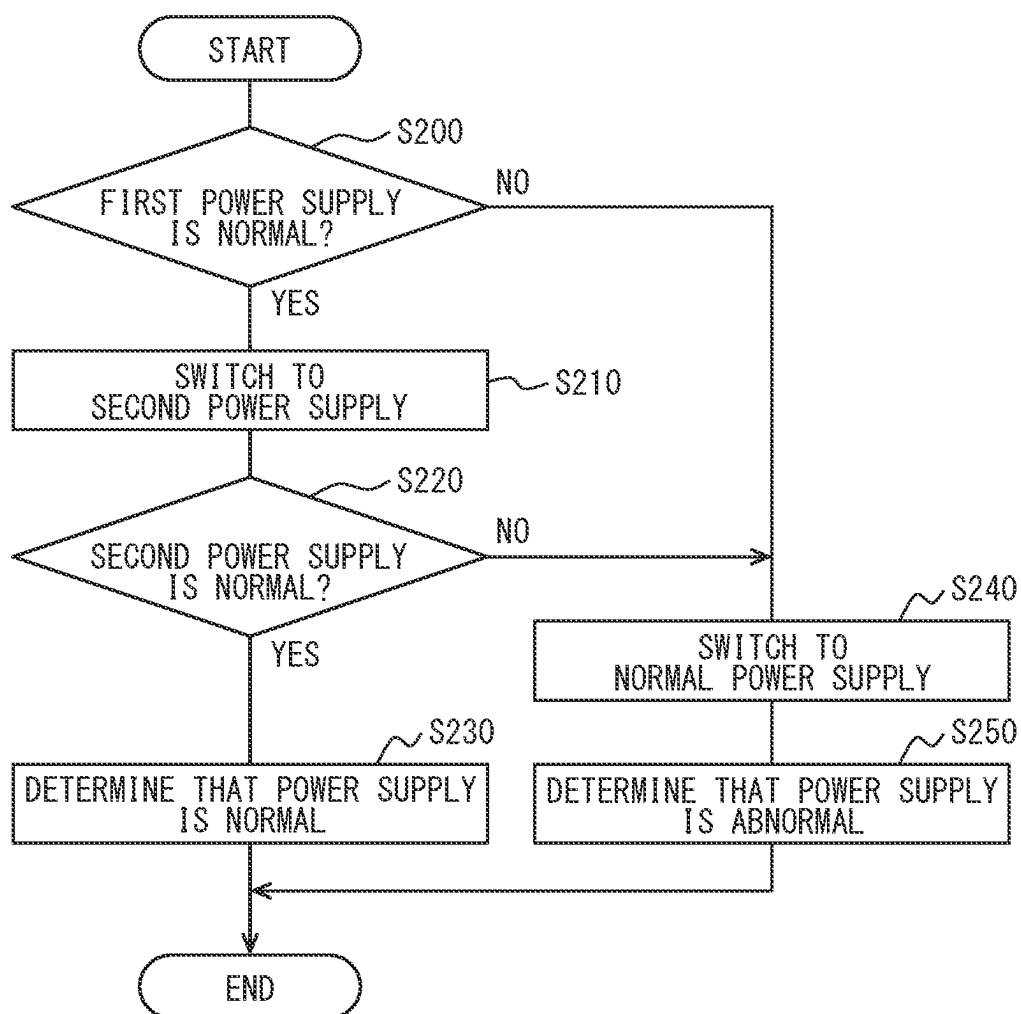
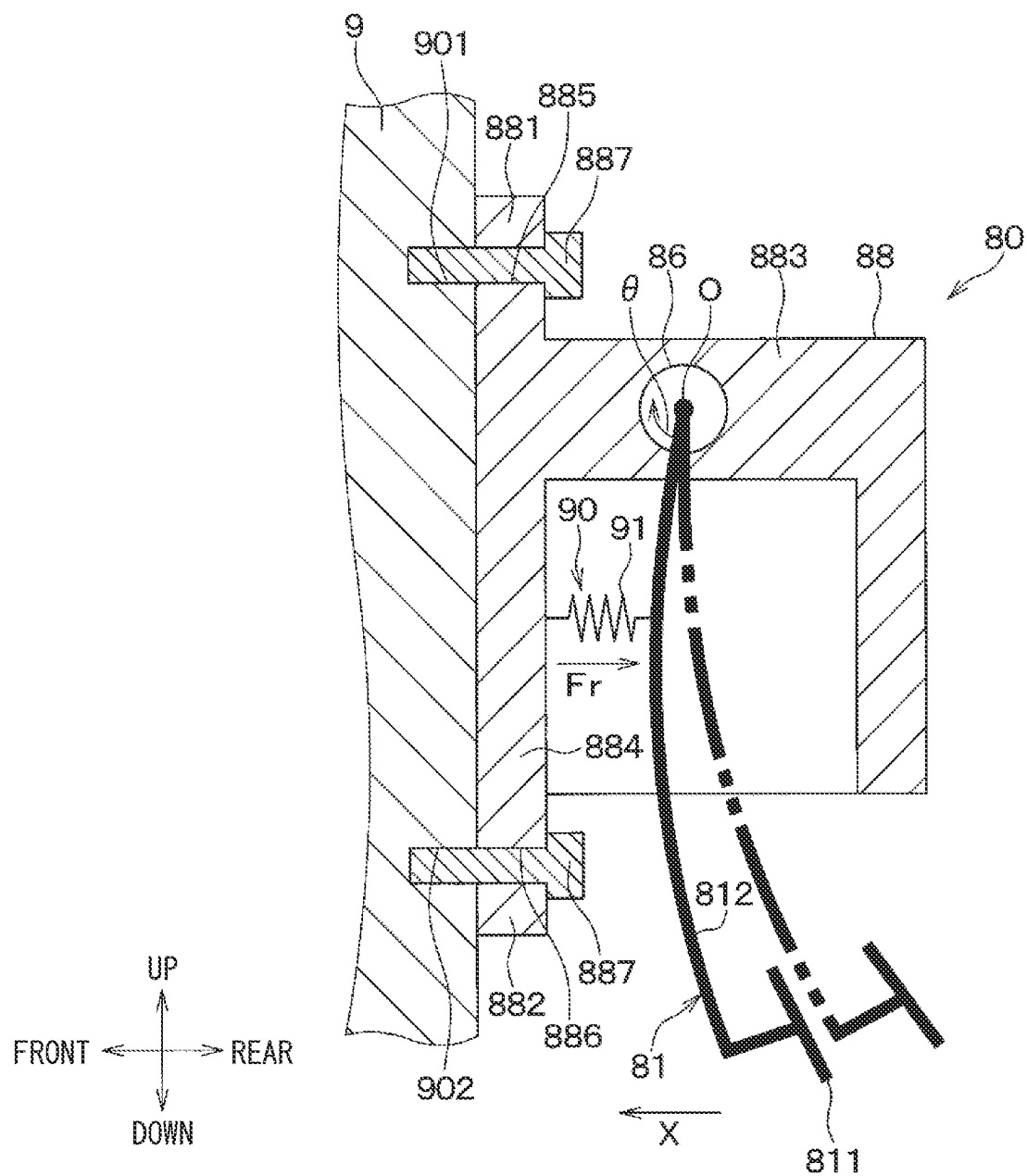
**FIG. 9**

FIG. 10



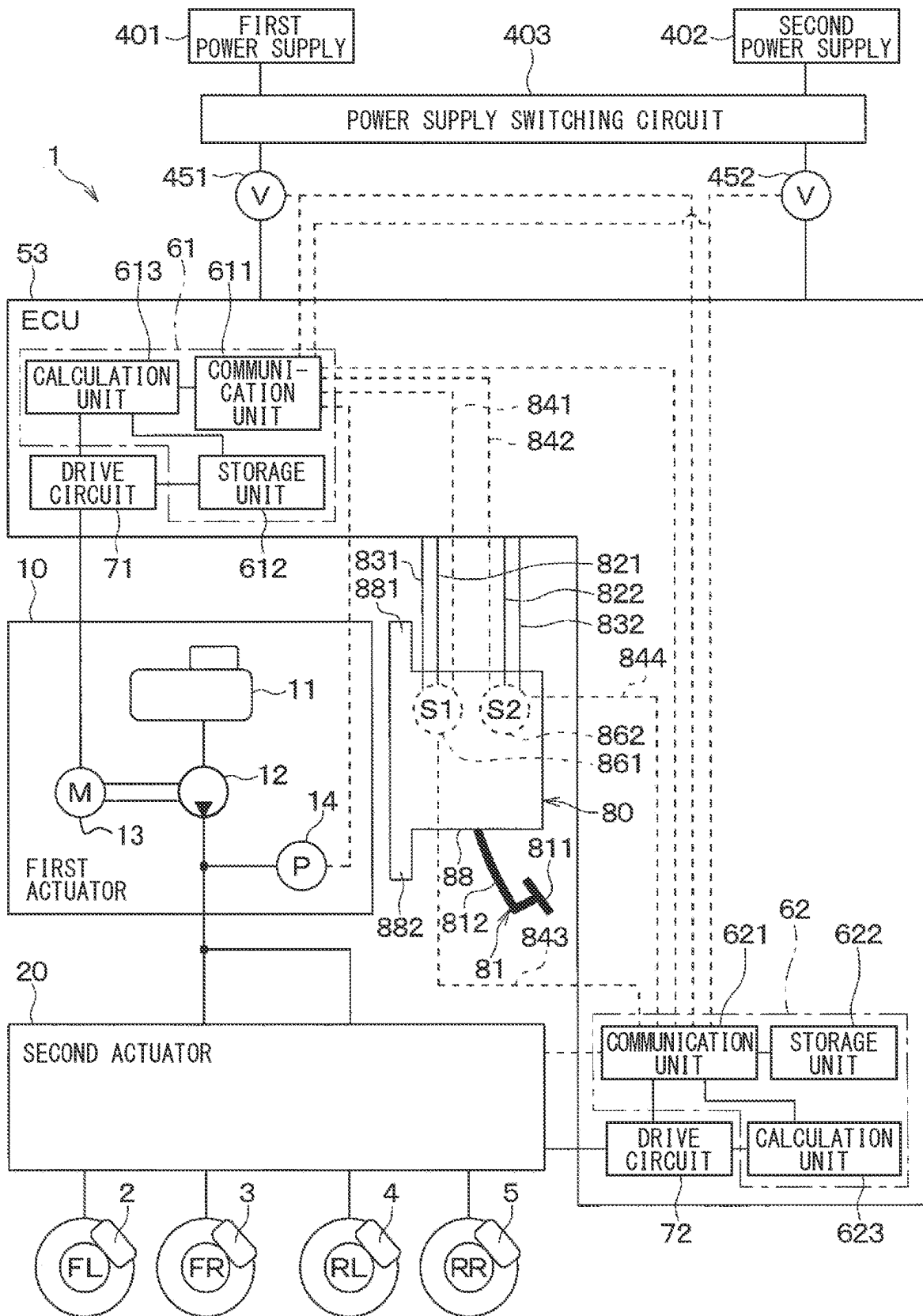
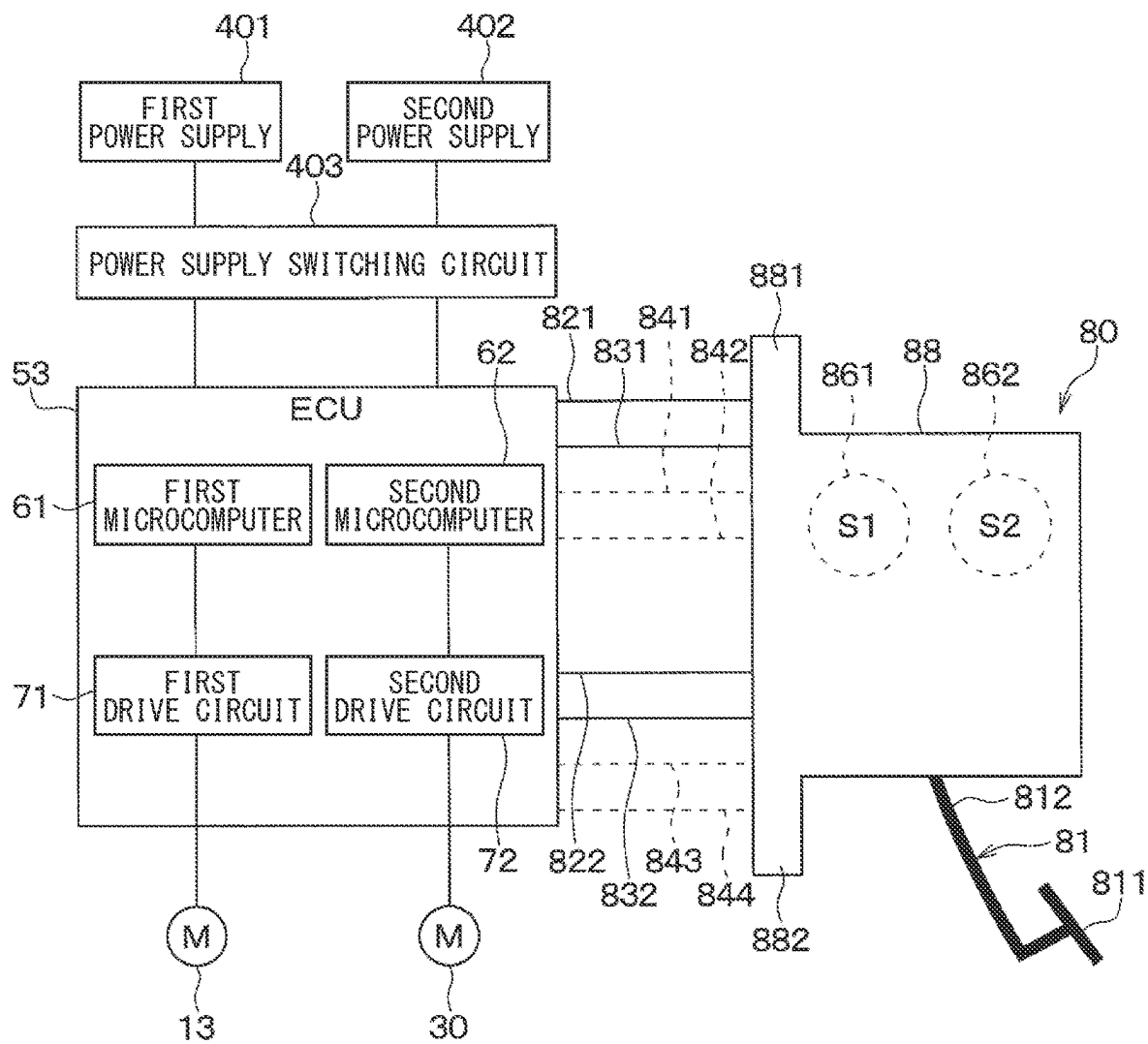
**FIG. 11**

FIG. 12



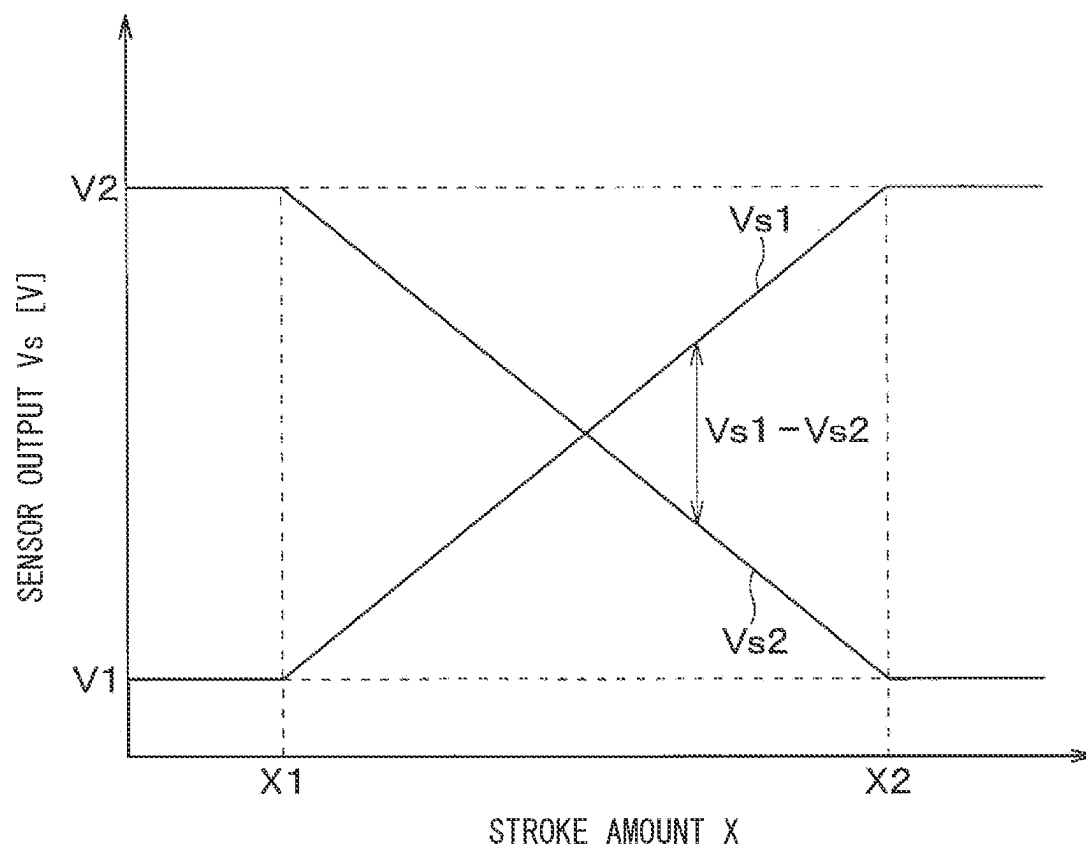
**FIG. 13**

FIG. 14

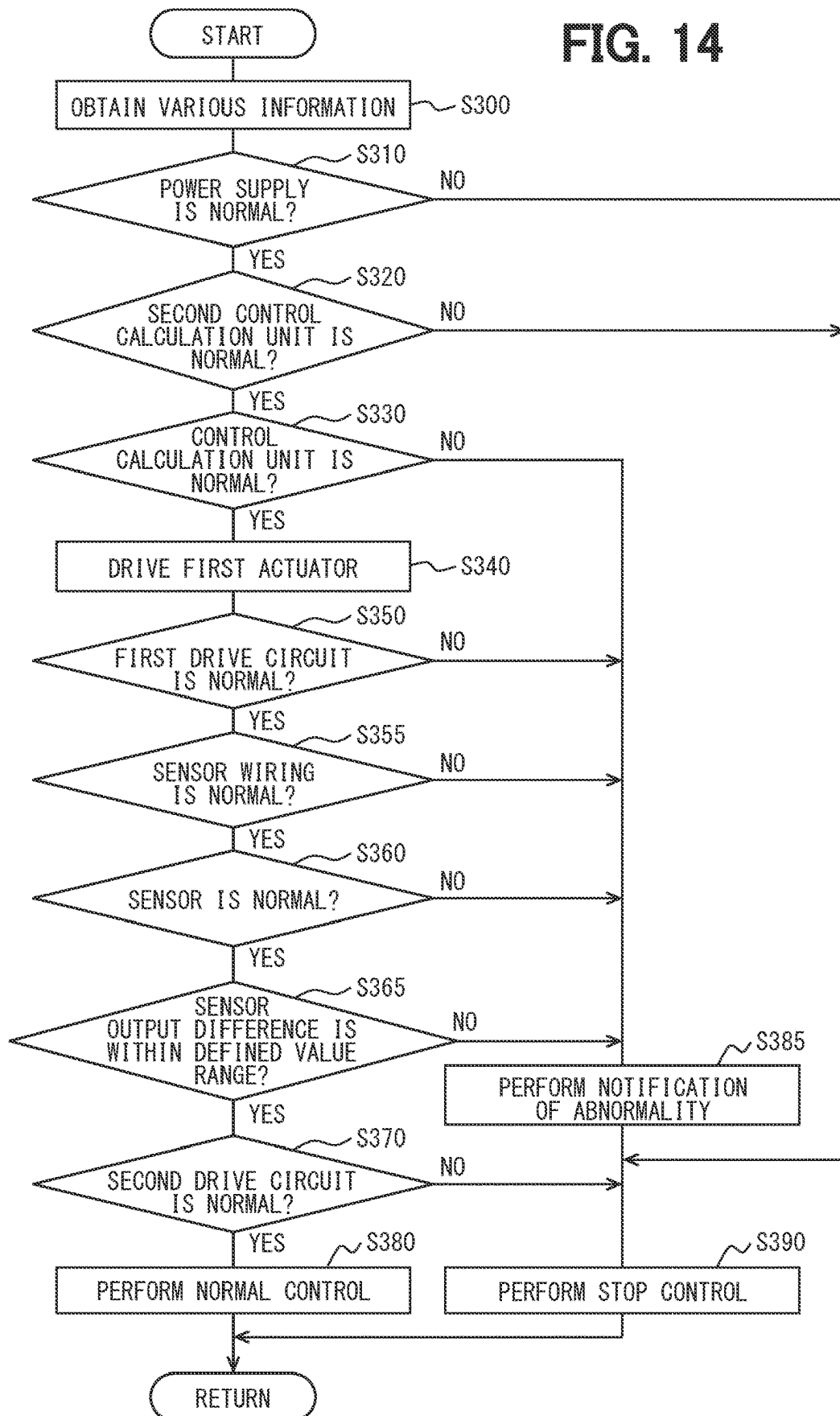


FIG. 15

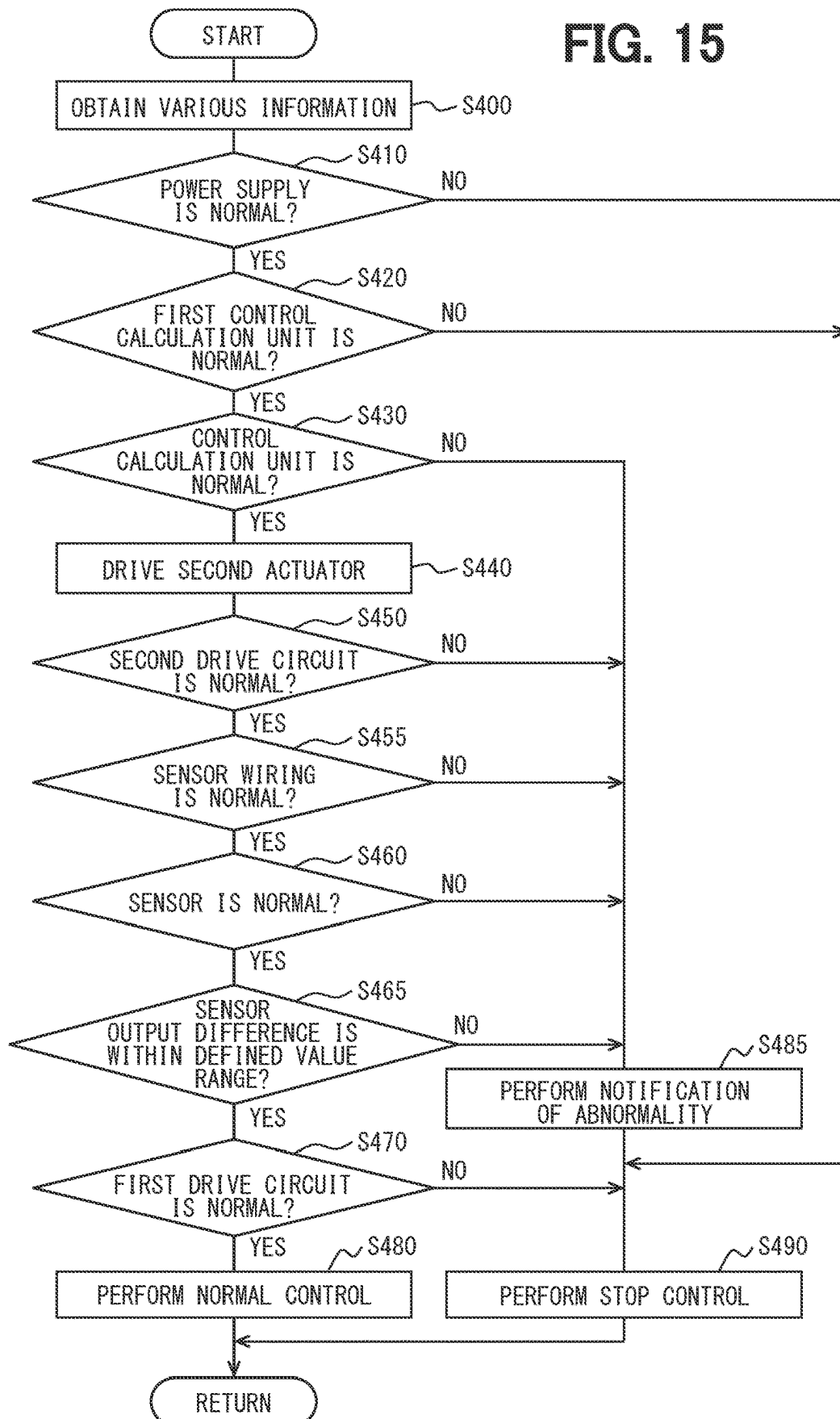
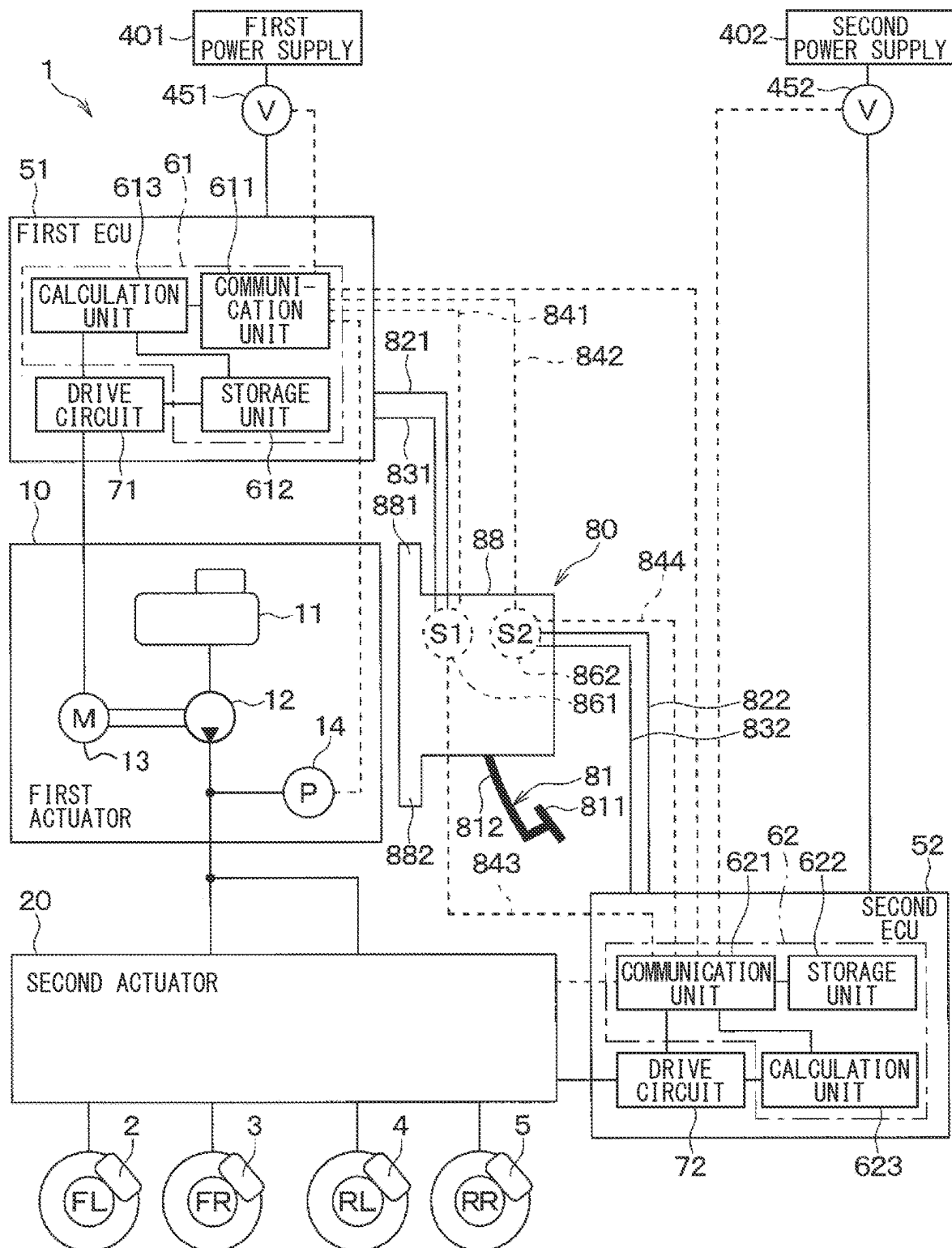
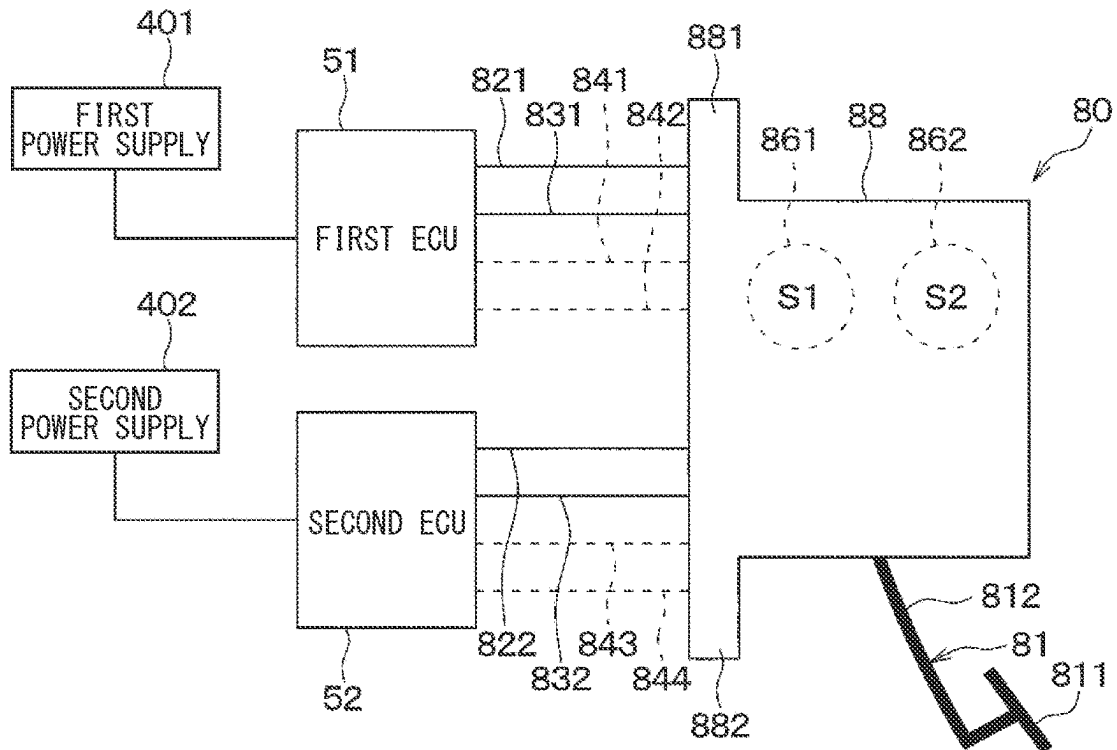


FIG. 16





**FIG. 17**



**FIG. 18**

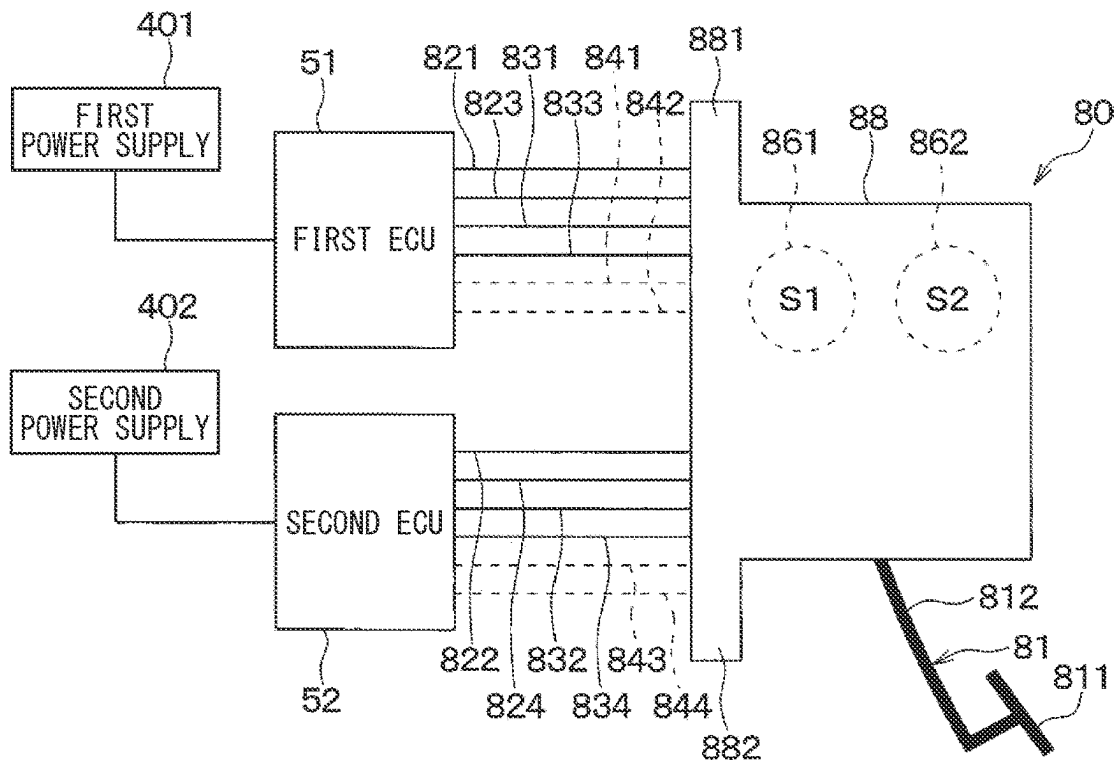




FIG. 20

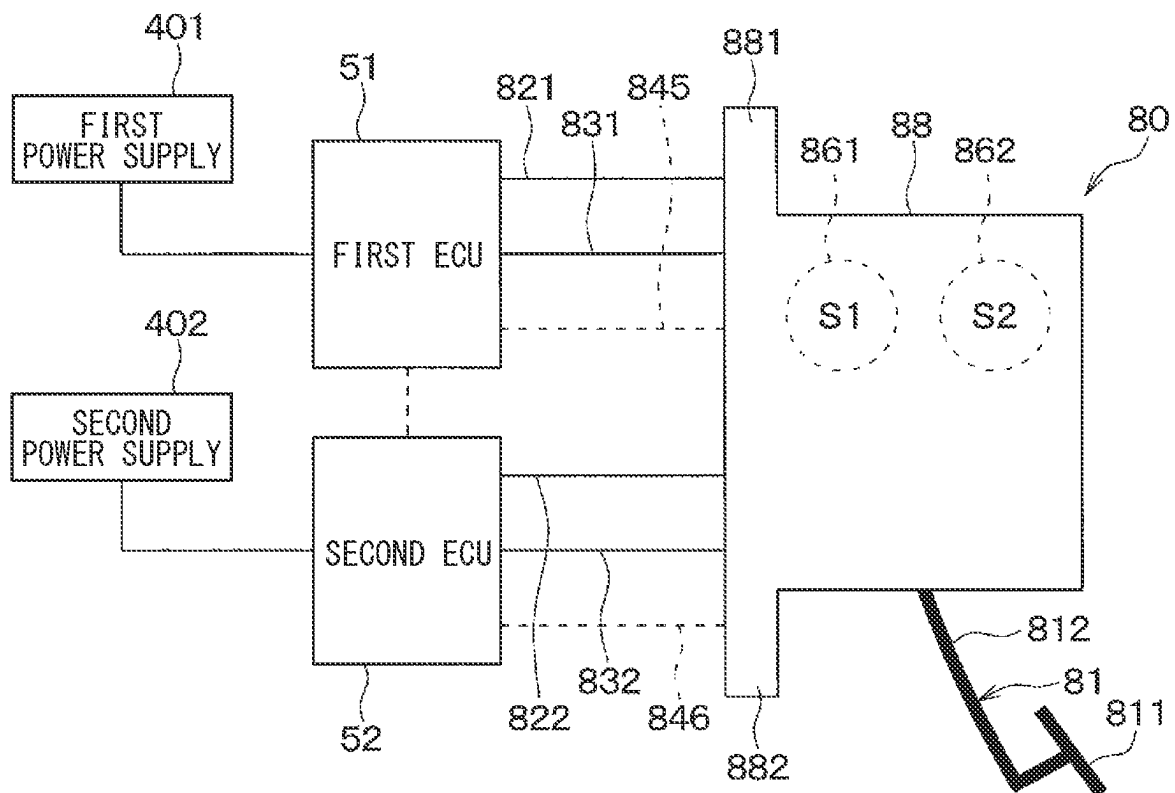
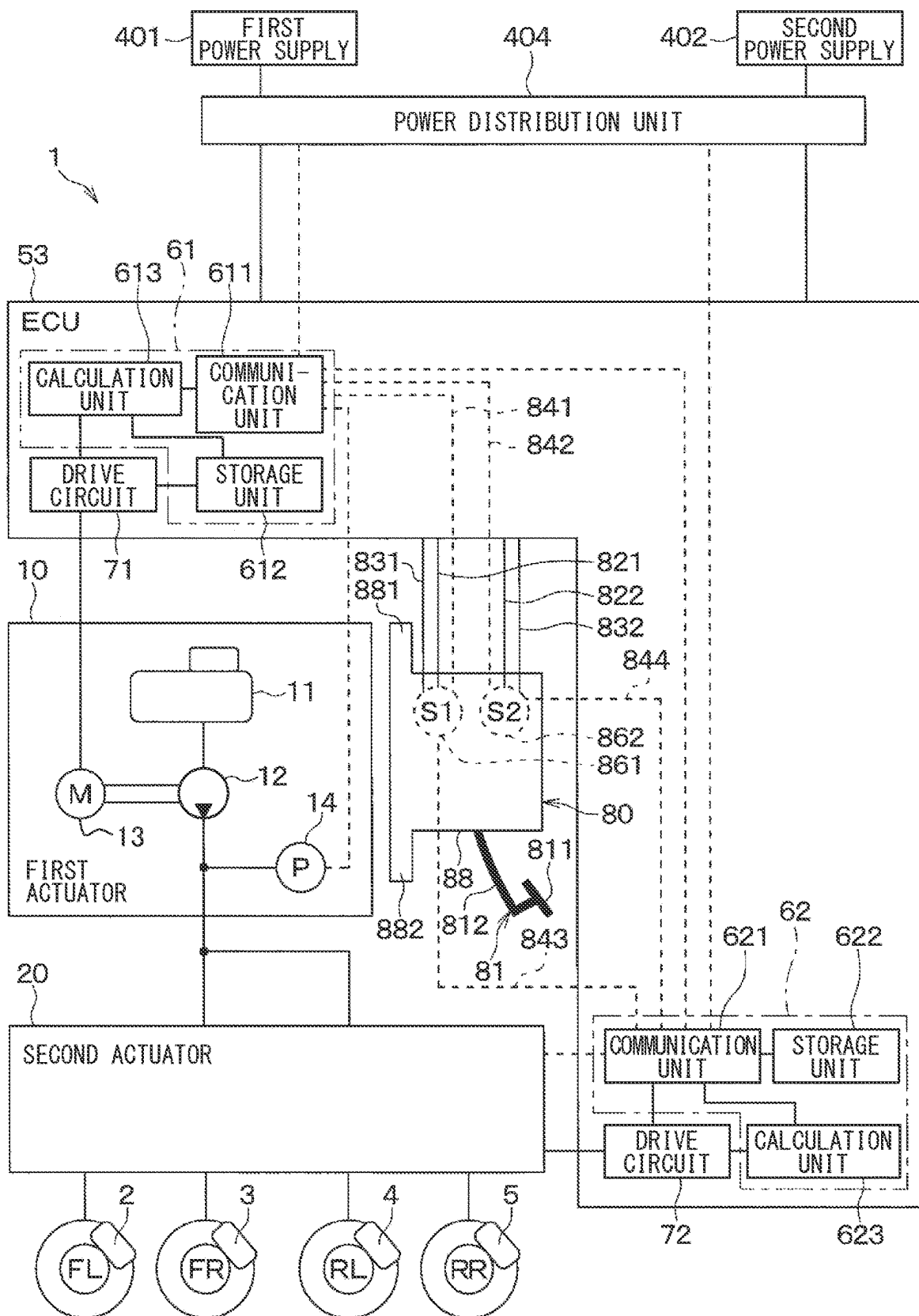


FIG. 21



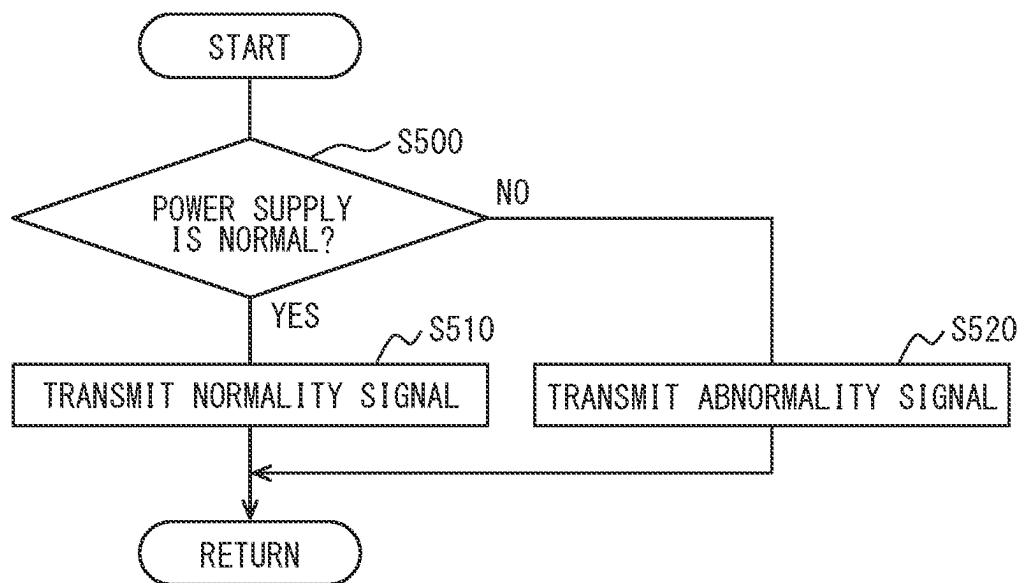
**FIG. 22**

FIG. 23

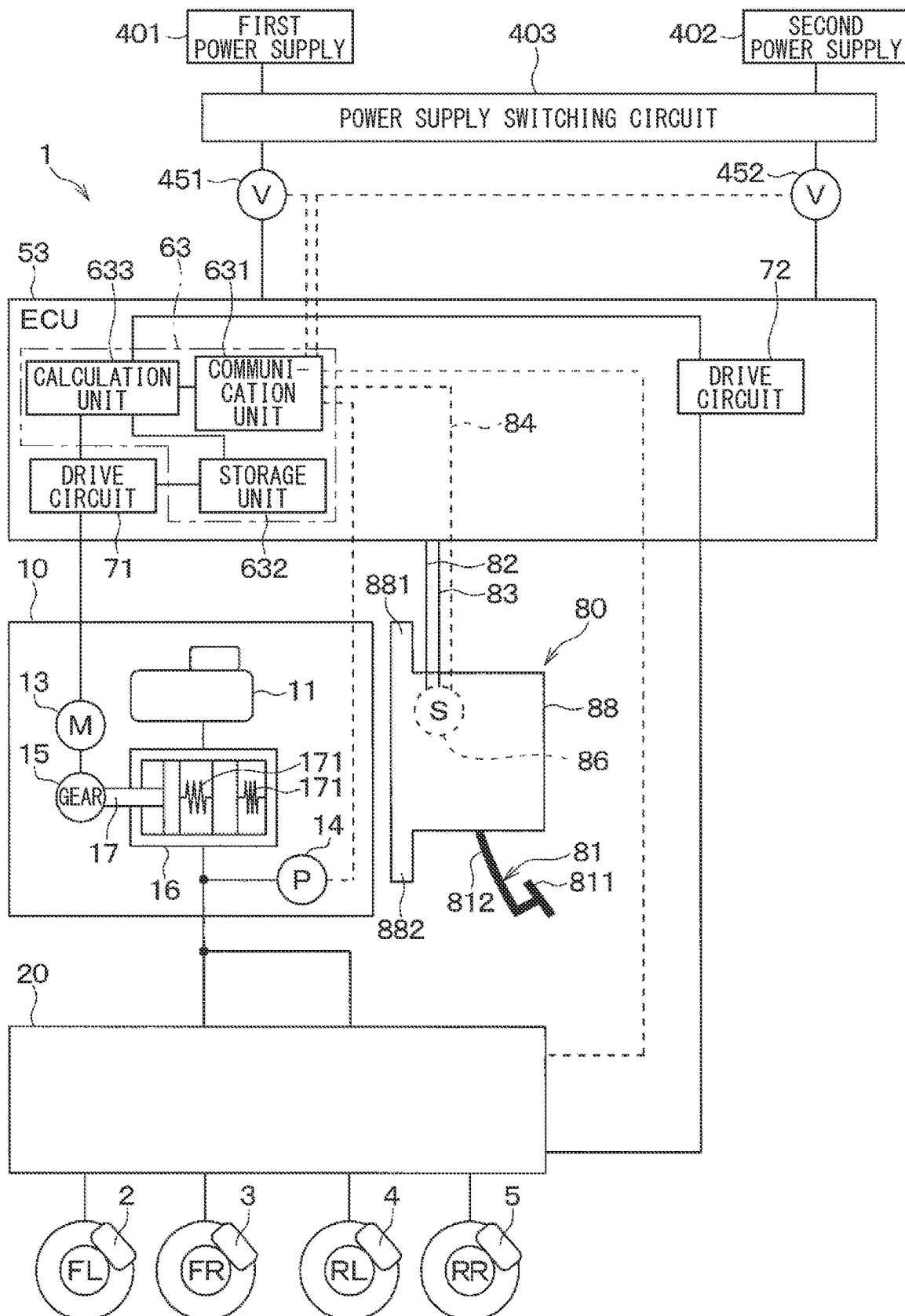


FIG. 24

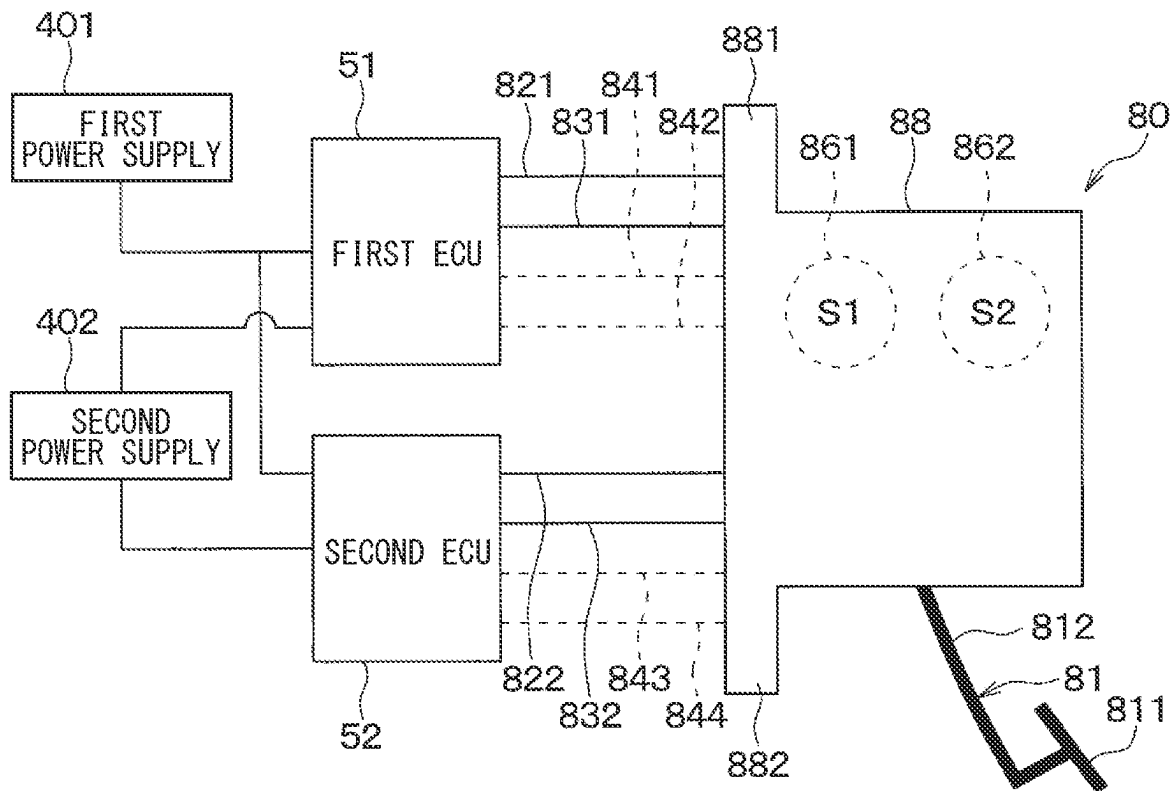
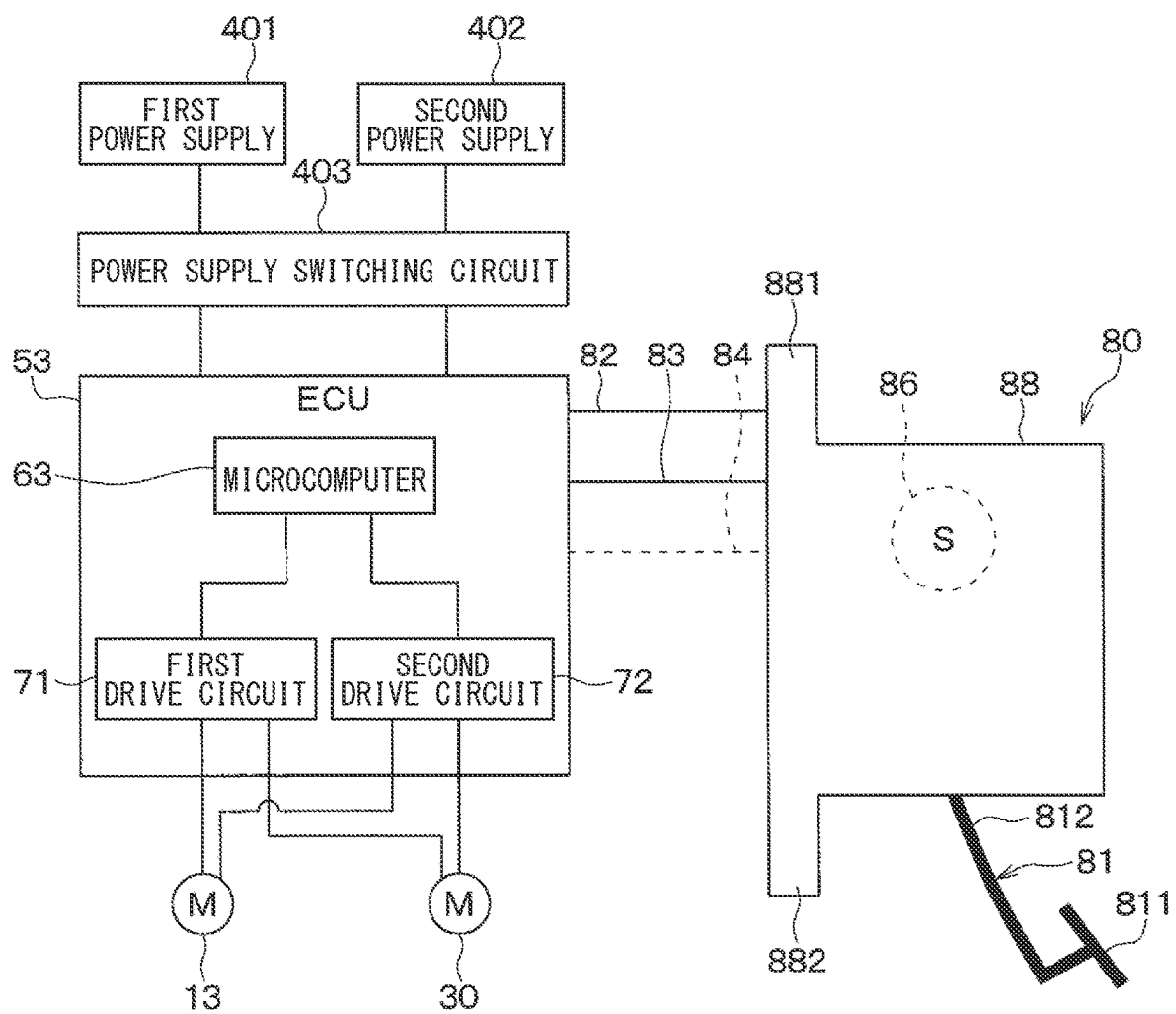


FIG. 25





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**VEHICLE BRAKE SYSTEM****CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS**

The present application is a continuation application of International Patent Application No. PCT/JP2020/046371 filed on Dec. 11, 2020, which designated the U.S. and claims the benefit of priority from Japanese Patent Application No. 2019-225659 filed on Dec. 13, 2019. The entire disclosures of all of the above applications are incorporated herein by reference.

**TECHNICAL FIELD**

The present disclosure relates to a vehicle brake system.

**BACKGROUND**

A vehicle brake system including a main power supply and a sub power supply has been proposed.

**SUMMARY**

The present disclosure provides a vehicle brake system. The vehicle brake system includes a vehicle brake device and a hydraulic pressure generation unit. The vehicle brake device includes: a brake pedal that has a pedal portion, and a lever portion rotating about a rotation axis in response to the pedal portion being operated; a stroke sensor that outputs a signal based on a stroke amount of the brake pedal; a housing that rotatably supports the lever portion; and a reaction force generation portion that generates a reaction force applied on the lever portion based on the stroke amount. The hydraulic pressure generation unit generates a hydraulic pressure for braking a vehicle.

**BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS**

The features and advantages of the present disclosure will become more apparent from the following detailed description made with reference to the accompanying drawings. In the drawings:

FIG. 1 is a configuration diagram of a vehicle brake system according to a first embodiment;

FIG. 2 is a configuration diagram of a second actuator;

FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view of a vehicle brake device;

FIG. 4 is a wiring diagram of the vehicle brake system;

FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating a relationship between stroke amount and sensor output;

FIG. 6 is a view when the vehicle brake device is mounted to a vehicle;

FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating a relationship between the stroke amount and reaction force;

FIG. 8 is a flowchart illustrating processing executed by a control calculation section;

FIG. 9 is a sub flowchart illustrating processing executed by the control calculation section;

FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view of the vehicle brake device when a brake pedal is pressed;

FIG. 11 is a configuration diagram of a vehicle brake system according to a second embodiment;

FIG. 12 is a wiring diagram of the vehicle brake system;

FIG. 13 is a diagram illustrating a relationship between the stroke amount and sensor output;

FIG. 14 is a flowchart illustrating processing executed by a first control calculation section;

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FIG. 15 is a flowchart illustrating processing executed by a second control calculation section;

FIG. 16 is a configuration diagram of a vehicle brake system according to a third embodiment;

FIG. 17 is a wiring diagram of the vehicle brake system;

FIG. 18 is a wiring diagram of a vehicle brake system according to a fourth embodiment;

FIG. 19 is a configuration diagram of a vehicle brake system according to a fifth embodiment;

FIG. 20 is a wiring diagram of the vehicle brake system;

FIG. 21 is a configuration diagram of a vehicle brake system according to a sixth embodiment;

FIG. 22 is a flowchart of a power distribution unit;

FIG. 23 is a configuration diagram of a vehicle brake system according to a seventh embodiment;

FIG. 24 is a wiring diagram of a vehicle brake system according to an eighth embodiment; and

FIG. 25 is a wiring diagram of a vehicle brake system according to another embodiment.

**DETAILED DESCRIPTION**

According to the inventors' studies, even when the main power supply and the sub power supply are provided, a vehicle may not be braked if a drive circuit for driving an actuator such as a motor fails. Thus, redundancy of the system may not be ensured in some cases.

The present disclosure provides a vehicle brake system that improves redundancy of the system.

An exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure provides a vehicle brake system that includes a vehicle brake device, a hydraulic pressure generation unit, a hydraulic pressure control device, a first power supply, and a second power supply. The vehicle brake device includes: a brake pedal that has a pedal portion, and a lever portion rotating about a rotation axis in response to the pedal portion being operated; a stroke sensor that outputs a signal based on a stroke amount of the brake pedal; a housing that rotatably supports the lever portion; and a reaction force generation portion that generates a reaction force applied on the lever portion based on the stroke amount. The hydraulic pressure generation unit generates a hydraulic pressure for braking a vehicle. The hydraulic pressure control device includes: a first drive circuit that drives the hydraulic pressure generation unit; and a second drive circuit that drives the hydraulic pressure control device. The hydraulic pressure control device controls the first drive circuit and the second drive circuit based on the signal from the stroke sensor to control the hydraulic pressure generated by the hydraulic pressure generation unit. The first power supply supplies power to the hydraulic pressure control device. The second power supply supplies power to the hydraulic pressure control device.

In the exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the redundancy of the vehicle brake system can be improved.

Hereinafter, embodiments will be described with reference to the drawings. In the following embodiments, the same or equivalent portions are denoted by the same reference signs, and the description thereof will be omitted.

**First Embodiment**

A vehicle brake system 1 according to a first embodiment controls a left front wheel FL, a right front wheel FR, a left rear wheel RL, and a right rear wheel RR, which are the wheels of a vehicle 6. First, the vehicle brake system 1 will be described.

As illustrated in FIG. 1, the vehicle brake system 1 includes a wheel cylinder for the left front wheel, a wheel cylinder for the right front wheel, a wheel cylinder for the left rear wheel, and a wheel cylinder for the right rear wheel. The vehicle brake system 1 further includes a first actuator 10, a second actuator 20, a first power supply 401, a first voltage sensor 451, a second power supply 402, a second voltage sensor 452, a power supply switching circuit 403, an ECU 53, and a vehicle brake device 80. Hereinafter, each of the wheel cylinders is referred to as the W/C for convenience. The ECU is an abbreviation for Electronic Control Unit.

The left front wheel W/C 2 is disposed on the left front wheel FL. The right front wheel W/C 3 is disposed on the right front wheel FR. The left rear wheel W/C 4 is disposed on the left rear wheel RL. The right rear wheel W/C 5 is disposed on the right rear wheel RR. The left front wheel W/C 2, the right front wheel W/C 3, the left rear wheel W/C 4, and the right rear wheel W/C 5 are connected to respective brake pads (not illustrated) of the vehicle 6.

The first actuator 10 corresponds to a first hydraulic pressure generation unit, and generates a brake hydraulic pressure. The first actuator 10 increases the brake hydraulic pressures to cause respective brake hydraulic pressures of the left front wheel W/C 2, the right front wheel W/C 3, the left rear wheel W/C 4, and the right rear wheel W/C 5 to increase. Specifically, the first actuator 10 includes a reservoir 11, a first pump 12, a first actuator motor 13, and a first pressure sensor 14.

The reservoir 11 stores a brake fluid such as oil or the like, and also supplies the brake fluid to the first pump 12.

The first pump 12 is driven by the first actuator motor 13, which corresponds to a first motor. With this driving, the first pump 12 increases a pressure of the brake fluid from the reservoir 11. The brake fluid with the increased hydraulic pressure flows from the first actuator 10 to the second actuator 20.

The first pressure sensor 14 outputs, to the ECU 53, a signal being in accordance with the hydraulic pressure of the brake fluid flowing to the second actuator 20.

The second actuator 20 corresponds to a second hydraulic pressure generation unit, and generates brake hydraulic pressures. The second actuator 20 controls the respective brake hydraulic pressures of the left front wheel W/C 2, the right front wheel W/C 3, the left rear wheel W/C 4, and the right rear wheel W/C 5, based on signals from the ECU 53 described later. For example, as illustrated in FIG. 2, the second actuator 20 includes a first piping system 21, a second piping system 26, and a second actuator motor 30.

The first piping system 21 controls the brake hydraulic pressures of the left front wheel W/C 2 and the right front wheel W/C 3. Specifically, the first piping system 21 includes a first main pipe line 211, a first differential pressure control valve 212, a second pressure sensor 213, a first branch pipe line 214, a first pressure increase control valve 215, and a first pressure reduction control valve 216. The first piping system 21 also includes a second branch pipe line 217, a second pressure increase control valve 218, a second pressure reduction control valve 219, a first pressure reduction pipe line 220, a first pressure adjustment reservoir 221, a first auxiliary pipe line 222, a first return-flow pipe line 223, and a second pump 224.

The first main pipe line 211 is connected to the first actuator 10, and transmits the brake hydraulic pressure from the first actuator 10 to the first differential pressure control valve 212.

The first differential pressure control valve 212 controls a differential pressure between an upstream side and a downstream side of the first main pipe line 211 using a signal from the ECU 53 described later. For example, when the brake hydraulic pressures on sides of the left front wheel W/C 2 and the right front wheel W/C 3 are higher than the brake hydraulic pressure on the side of the first actuator 10 by a predetermined pressure or higher, the first differential pressure control valve 212 allows a flow of the brake fluid from the sides of the left front wheel W/C 2 and the right front wheel W/C 3 to the side of the first actuator 10. As a result, the brake hydraulic pressures on the sides of the left front wheel W/C 2 and the right front wheel W/C 3 are maintained so as not to be higher than the brake hydraulic pressure on the side of the first actuator 10 by a predetermined pressure or higher.

The second pressure sensor 213 outputs a signal being in accordance with the brake hydraulic pressure on the downstream side of the first differential pressure control valve 212 to the ECU 53 described later.

The first branch pipe line 214 directs the brake fluid flowing from the first differential pressure control valve 212 to the first pressure increase control valve 215.

The first pressure increase control valve 215 is a normally open type two-position electromagnetic valve capable of controlling a communicating state and a blocking state. Specifically, when a solenoid coil (not illustrated) of the first pressure increase control valve 215 is in a non-energized state, the first pressure increase control valve 215 is in the communicating state, and thus allows a flow of the brake fluid to the left front wheel W/C 2 and the first pressure reduction control valve 216. When the solenoid coil (not illustrated) of the first pressure increase control valve 215 is in an energized state, the first pressure increase control valve 215 becomes the blocking state, and thus blocks the flow of the brake fluid to the left front wheel W/C 2 and the first pressure reduction control valve 216.

The first pressure reduction control valve 216 is a normally closed type two-position electromagnetic valve capable of controlling a blocking state and a communicating state. Specifically, when a solenoid coil (not illustrated) of the first pressure reduction control valve 216 is in a non-energized state, the first pressure reduction control valve 216 is in the blocking state, and thus blocks a flow of the brake fluid to the first pressure reduction pipe line 220 described later. When the solenoid coil (not illustrated) of the first pressure reduction control valve 216 is in an energized state, the first pressure reduction control valve 216 becomes the communicating state, and thus allows the flow of the brake fluid to the first pressure reduction pipe line 220 described later.

The second branch pipe line 217 directs the brake fluid flowing from the first differential pressure control valve 212 to the second pressure increase control valve 218.

Similar to the first pressure increase control valve 215, the second pressure increase control valve 218 is a normally open type two-position electromagnetic valve. Specifically, when a solenoid coil (not illustrated) of the second pressure increase control valve 218 is in a non-energized state, the second pressure increase control valve 218 is in a communicating state, and thus allows a flow of the brake fluid to the right front wheel W/C 3 and the second pressure reduction control valve 219. When the solenoid coil (not illustrated) of the second pressure increase control valve 218 is in an energized state, the second pressure increase control valve 218 becomes a blocking state, and thus blocks the flow of the

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brake fluid to the right front wheel W/C 3 and the second pressure reduction control valve 219.

Similar to the first pressure reduction control valve 216, the second pressure reduction control valve 219 is a normally closed type two-position electromagnetic valve. Specifically, when a solenoid coil (not illustrated) of the second pressure reduction control valve 219 is in a non-energized state, the second pressure reduction control valve 219 is in the blocking state, and thus blocks a flow of the brake fluid to the first pressure reduction pipe line 220 described later. When the solenoid coil (not illustrated) of the second pressure reduction control valve 219 is in an energized state, the second pressure reduction control valve 219 becomes the communicating state, and thus allows the flow of the brake fluid to the first pressure reduction pipe line 220 described later.

The first pressure reduction pipe line 220 directs the brake fluids flowing from the first pressure reduction control valve 216 and the second pressure reduction control valve 219 to the first pressure adjustment reservoir 221.

The first auxiliary pipe line 222 branches from the first main pipe line 211, and directs the brake fluid flowing from the first actuator 10 to the first pressure adjustment reservoir 221.

The first pressure adjustment reservoir 221 stores the brake fluids flowing from the first pressure reduction control valve 216 and the second pressure reduction control valve 219 through the first pressure reduction pipe line 220. The first pressure adjustment reservoir 221 also stores the brake fluid flowing from the first actuator 10 through the first auxiliary pipe line 222. Further, when the brake fluid is sucked by the second pump 224 described later, the first pressure adjustment reservoir 221 adjusts a flow rate of the stored brake fluid.

The first return-flow pipe line 223 is connected between the first differential pressure control valve 212 and each of the first pressure increase control valve 215 and the second pressure increase control valve 218. The first return-flow pipe line 223 is connected to the second pump 224.

The second pump 224 is connected to the first pressure reduction pipe line 220, and is driven by the second actuator motor 30, which corresponds to a second motor. With this driving, the second pump 224 sucks the brake fluid stored in the first pressure adjustment reservoir 221. The sucked brake fluid flows between the first differential pressure control valve 212 and each of the first pressure increase control valve 215 and the second pressure increase control valve 218 after the brake fluid flows through the first return-flow pipe line 223. As a result, the respective brake hydraulic pressures of the left front wheel W/C 2 and the right front wheel W/C 3 increase.

The second piping system 26 controls the brake hydraulic pressures of the left rear wheel W/C 4 and the right rear wheel W/C 5. Specifically, the second piping system 26 includes a second main pipe line 261, a second differential pressure control valve 262, a third pressure sensor 263, a third branch pipe line 264, a third pressure increase control valve 265, and a third pressure reduction control valve 266. The second piping system 26 also includes a fourth branch pipe line 267, a fourth pressure increase control valve 268, a fourth pressure reduction control valve 269, a second pressure reduction pipe line 270, a second pressure adjustment reservoir 271, a second auxiliary pipe line 272, a second return-flow pipe line 273, and a third pump 274.

Herein, the second piping system 26 is configured similarly to the first piping system 21. Thus, the left front wheel W/C 2 described above is replaced by the right rear wheel

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W/C 5. The right front wheel W/C 3 described above is replaced by the left rear wheel W/C 4. Further, the second main pipe line 261 corresponds to the first main pipe line 211. The second differential pressure control valve 262 corresponds to the first differential pressure control valve 212. The third pressure sensor 263 corresponds to the second pressure sensor 213. The third branch pipe line 264 corresponds to the first branch pipe line 214. The third pressure increase control valve 265 corresponds to the first pressure increase control valve 215. The third pressure reduction control valve 266 corresponds to the first pressure reduction control valve 216. The fourth branch pipe line 267 corresponds to the second branch pipe line 217. The fourth pressure increase control valve 268 corresponds to the second pressure increase control valve 218. The fourth pressure reduction control valve 269 corresponds to the second pressure reduction control valve 219. The second pressure reduction pipe line 270 corresponds to the first pressure reduction pipe line 220. The second pressure adjustment reservoir 271 corresponds to the first pressure adjustment reservoir 221. The second auxiliary pipe line 272 corresponds to the first auxiliary pipe line 222. The second return-flow pipe line 273 corresponds to the first return-flow pipe line 223. The third pump 274 corresponds to the second pump 224.

The first power supply 401 supplies power to the ECU 53.

The first voltage sensor 451 outputs, to the ECU 53, a signal being in accordance with a voltage applied from the first power supply 401 to the ECU 53.

The second power supply 402 supplies power to the ECU 53.

The second voltage sensor 452 outputs, to the ECU 53, a signal being in accordance with a voltage applied from the second power supply 402 to the ECU 53.

The power supply switching circuit 403 switches a power supply source that supplies power to the ECU 53 to either the first power supply 401 or the second power supply 402 based on a signal from the ECU 53 described later.

The ECU 53 corresponds to a hydraulic pressure control device, and controls the first actuator 10 by controlling the first actuator motor 13. The ECU 53 also controls the second actuator 20 by controlling the second actuator motor 30. Further, the ECU 53 switches the power supply source that supplies power to the ECU 53 to either the first power supply 401 or the second power supply 402 by controlling the power supply switching circuit 403. Specifically, the ECU 53 includes a microcomputer 63, a first drive circuit 71, and a second drive circuit 72.

The microcomputer 63 corresponds to a hydraulic pressure control unit, and controls the first actuator 10 by controlling the first drive circuit 71 described later. The microcomputer 63 controls the second actuator 20 by controlling the second drive circuit 72 described later. Specifically, the microcomputer 63 includes a communication section 631, a storage section 632, and a control calculation section 633.

The communication section 631 includes an interface for communicating with the first pressure sensor 14, an interface for communicating with the second pressure sensor 213, and an interface for communicating with the third pressure sensor 263. The communication section 631 also includes an interface for communicating with the first voltage sensor 451 and an interface for communicating with the second voltage sensor 452. The communication section 631 further includes an interface for communicating with a stroke sensor 86 of the vehicle brake device 80, described later.

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The storage section **632** includes non-volatile memories such as a read-only memory (ROM) and a flash memory, and a volatile memory such as a random access memory (RAM). The non-volatile memories and the volatile memory are non-transitory tangible storage media.

The control calculation section **633** includes a central processing unit (CPU) and the like. The control calculation section **633** outputs a signal for driving the first actuator motor **13** to the first drive circuit **71** by executing a program stored in the ROM of the storage section **632**. The control calculation section **633** also outputs a signal for driving the second actuator motor **30** to the second drive circuit **72** by executing a program stored in the ROM of the storage section **632**. The control calculation section **633** further outputs, to the power supply switching circuit **403**, the signal for switching the power supply source that supplies power to the ECU **53** by executing a program stored in the ROM of the storage section **632**.

The first drive circuit **71** includes, for example, a switching element and the like, and drives the first actuator **10** by supplying power to the first actuator motor **13** based on the signal from the control calculation section **633**.

The second drive circuit **72** includes, for example, a switching element and the like, and drives the second actuator **20** by supplying power to each valve of the second actuator **20** and the second actuator motor **30** based on the signal from the control calculation section **633**.

As illustrated in FIGS. **1**, **3**, and **4**, the vehicle brake device **80** includes a brake pedal **81**, a sensor power supply line **82**, a sensor ground line **83**, a sensor output line **84**, the stroke sensor **86**, a housing **88**, and a reaction force generation portion **90**.

The brake pedal **81** is operated by a driver of the vehicle **6** pressing the brake pedal **81**. Specifically, the brake pedal **81** includes a pedal portion **811** and a lever portion **812**. The pedal portion **811** is pressed by the driver of the vehicle **6**. The lever portion **812** is connected to the pedal portion **811**, and rotates about a rotation axis **O** when the pedal portion **811** is pressed by the driver of the vehicle **6**.

As illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **4**, the sensor power supply line **82** is connected to the ECU **53** and the stroke sensor **86** described later. With this connection, power from the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** is supplied to the stroke sensor **86** through the ECU **53** and the sensor power supply line **82**.

The sensor ground line **83** is connected to the ECU **53** and the stroke sensor **86**.

The sensor output line **84** is connected to the ECU **53** and the stroke sensor **86**.

As illustrated in FIG. **3**, the stroke sensor **86** is disposed, for example, next to the rotation axis **O** of the lever portion **812**. As illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **4**, the stroke sensor **86** outputs a signal being in accordance with a stroke amount **X** to the ECU **53** through the sensor output line **84**. The stroke amount **X** is an operation amount of the brake pedal **81** generated by a pedal force of the driver of the vehicle **6**. Herein, the stroke amount **X** is, for example, an amount of translational movement of the pedal portion **811** toward the front of the vehicle **6**. As illustrated in FIG. **5**, the stroke amount **X** and a sensor output **Vs** of the stroke sensor **86** are adjusted to have a linear relationship. Herein, the sensor output **Vs** is expressed by, for example, voltage. Alternatively, the stroke sensor **86** may also output a signal being in accordance with a rotation angle  $\theta$  about the rotation axis **O** of the lever portion **812** to the ECU **53** through the sensor output line **84**. At this time, similarly to the relationship between the stroke amount **X** and the sensor output **Vs**, the

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rotation angle  $\theta$  and the signal of the stroke sensor **86** are adjusted to have a linear relationship.

As illustrated in FIGS. **3** and **6**, the housing **88** is mounted to a dash panel **9**, which is a partition wall that separates a cabin **8** from a non-cabin space **7** such as an engine compartment and the like of the vehicle **6**. In some cases, the dash panel **9** is referred to as a bulkhead. In the non-cabin space **7**, in addition to an engine of the vehicle **6**, a battery, an air conditioning device, and the like of the vehicle **6** are disposed.

As illustrated in FIG. **3**, the housing **88** is formed in a bottomed tubular shape, and includes a first mounting portion **881**, a second mounting portion **882**, a housing bottom portion **883**, and a housing tubular portion **884**. Herein, the upside with respect to the front of the vehicle **6** is simply referred to as the upside, for convenience of explanation. The downside with respect to the front of the vehicle **6** is simply referred to as the downside.

The first mounting portion **881** is connected to the housing bottom portion **883** described later, and extends upward from the housing bottom portion **883**. The first mounting portion **881** includes a first mounting hole **885**. The first mounting portion **881** is mounted to the dash panel **9** by inserting a bolt **887** into the first mounting hole **885** and a first hole **901** of the dash panel **9**. Herein, the bolt **887** is inserted so as not to penetrate through the dash panel **9**.

The second mounting portion **882** is connected to the housing tubular portion **884** described later, and extends downward from the housing tubular portion **884**. The second mounting portion **882** includes a second mounting hole **886**. The second mounting portion **882** is mounted to the dash panel **9** by inserting another bolt **887** into the second mounting hole **886** and a second hole **902** of the dash panel **9**.

The housing bottom portion **883** supports a part of the lever portion **812** such that the lever portion **812** is rotatable about the rotation axis **O**. The housing bottom portion **883** also supports the stroke sensor **86**.

The housing tubular portion **884** has a tubular shape, is connected to the housing bottom portion **883**, and extends downward from the housing bottom portion **883**. The housing tubular portion **884** houses a part of the lever portion **812**.

The reaction force generation portion **90** is connected to the housing tubular portion **884** and the lever portion **812**, and generates a reaction force **Fr** applied on the lever portion **812** in accordance with the stroke amount **X**. Specifically, the reaction force generation portion **90** includes an elastic member **91**.

The elastic member **91** is, for example, a helical compression spring. The elastic member **91** is connected to an inner front side of the housing tubular portion **884** and the lever portion **812**. Thus, when the brake pedal **81** is operated by the pedal force of the driver of the vehicle **6**, a force that corresponds to the pedal force is transmitted from the lever portion **812** to the elastic member **91**. As a result, the elastic member **91** is elastically deformed, that is, contracts herein, and thus a restoration force is generated. This restoration force generates the reaction force **Fr** applied on the lever portion **812**. The restoration force of the elastic member **91** is proportional to a deformation amount of the elastic member **91**. The deformation amount of the elastic member **91** is proportional to the stroke amount **X**. Thus, the restoration force of the elastic member **91** is proportional to the stroke amount **X**. Therefore, as illustrated in FIG. **7**, the stroke amount **X** and the reaction force **Fr** have a linear

relationship. Herein, the rotation angle  $\theta$  described above is also adjusted to have a linear relationship with the reaction force  $F_r$ .

The vehicle brake system 1 is configured as described above. The left front wheel FL, the right front wheel FR, the left rear wheel RL, and the right rear wheel RR of the vehicle 6 are controlled by processing of the control calculation section 633 of the ECU 53 in the vehicle brake system 1.

Next, the processing of the control calculation section 633 will be described with reference to a flowchart of FIG. 8. Here, for example, when an ignition of the vehicle 6 is turned on, the control calculation section 633 executes the programs stored in the ROM of the storage section 632. In an initial state, the first power supply 401 is set as the power supply source that supplies power to the ECU 53.

In step S100, the control calculation section 633 obtains various information. Specifically, the control calculation section 633 obtains a first voltage  $V_{b1}$ , which is the voltage applied from the first power supply 401 to the ECU 53, from the first voltage sensor 451 through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 also obtains the hydraulic pressure of the brake fluid flowing from the first actuator 10 to the second actuator 20, from the first pressure sensor 14 through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 further obtains the brake hydraulic pressure on the downstream side of the first differential pressure control valve 212 from the second pressure sensor 213 through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 also obtains the brake hydraulic pressure on the downstream side of the second differential pressure control valve 262 from the third pressure sensor 263 through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 further obtains the sensor output  $V_s$  that corresponds to the stroke amount  $X$  of the brake pedal 81 from the stroke sensor 86 through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 also obtains a yaw rate, which is a rate of change in rotation angle of the vehicle 6 in the turning direction, from a yaw rate sensor (not illustrated) through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 further obtains acceleration of the vehicle 6 from an acceleration sensor (not illustrated) through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 also obtains a steering angle of the vehicle 6 from a steering angle sensor (not illustrated) through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 further obtains wheel speeds of the left front wheel FL, the right front wheel FR, the left rear wheel RL, and the right rear wheel RR from wheel speed sensors (not illustrated) through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 also obtains a vehicle speed of the vehicle 6 from a vehicle speed sensor (not illustrated) through the communication section 631. Herein, the vehicle speed is abbreviation of the estimated vehicle body speed.

In step S110, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 are normal. Here, this determination will be described with reference to a flowchart of FIG. 9.

In step S200, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the first power supply 401 is normal. Specifically, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the first voltage  $V_{b1}$  obtained in step S100 is equal to or higher than a first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$  and equal to or lower than a second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ . When the first voltage  $V_{b1}$  is equal to or higher than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$  and equal to or lower than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ , the first power supply 401

is normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S210. When the first voltage  $V_{b1}$  is lower than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$ , the first power supply 401 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S240. When the first voltage  $V_{b1}$  is higher than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ , the first power supply 401 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S240. The first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$  and the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$  are set through experiments, simulations, or the like.

In step S210 subsequent to step S200, the control calculation section 633 outputs, to the power supply switching circuit 403, the signal for setting the second power supply 402 as the power supply source that supplies power to the ECU 53. With this output, the power supply switching circuit 403 switches the power supply source that supplies power to the ECU 53 from the first power supply 401 to the second power supply 402.

Subsequently, in step S220, the control calculation section 633 obtains a second voltage  $V_{b2}$ , which is the voltage applied from the second power supply 402 to the ECU 53, from the second voltage sensor 452 through the communication section 631. The control calculation section 633 determines whether the obtained second voltage  $V_{b2}$  is equal to or higher than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$  and equal to or lower than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ . When the second voltage  $V_{b2}$  is equal to or higher than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$  and equal to or lower than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ , the second power supply 402 is normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S230. When the second voltage  $V_{b2}$  is lower than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$ , the second power supply 402 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S240. When the second voltage  $V_{b2}$  is higher than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ , the second power supply 402 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S240.

In step S230 subsequent to step S220, since both of the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 are normal, the control calculation section 633 sets a power supply normality flag to ON, for example. Then, the processing proceeds to step S120.

In step S240, the first power supply 401 or the second power supply 402 is abnormal, and thus the control calculation section 633 determines which of the first power supply 401 or the second power supply 402 is normal. The control calculation section 633 outputs, to the power supply switching circuit 403, the signal for switching the power supply source that supplies power to the ECU 53 to the normal one. With this output, the power supply switching circuit 403 switches the power supply source that supplies power to the ECU 53 to the one of the first power supply 401 or the second power supply 402, which is normal. Then, the processing proceeds to step S250. When both of the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 are abnormal, the processing proceeds to step S250.

In step S250 subsequent to step S240, since the first power supply 401 or the second power supply 402 is abnormal, the control calculation section 633 sets a power supply abnormality flag to ON, for example. Then, the processing proceeds to step S190.

In this manner, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 are normal. Then, when the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 are normal, the processing proceeds to step S120. When the first power supply 401 or the second power supply 402 is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step S190.

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In step S120 subsequent to step S110, as illustrated in FIG. 8, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the control calculation section 633 itself is normal. For example, the control calculation section 633 periodically outputs a watchdog signal to a monitoring integrated circuit (IC) (not illustrated). The monitoring IC determines whether the monitoring IC has detected the watchdog signal from the control calculation section 633. Then, when the monitoring IC has detected the watchdog signal from the control calculation section 633, the monitoring IC determines that the control calculation section 633 is normal while the monitoring IC outputs a low-level signal to the control calculation section 633. When the control calculation section 633 receives the low-level signal from the monitoring IC, the control calculation section 633 is normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S130. When the monitoring IC does not detect the watchdog signal from the control calculation section 633, the monitoring IC outputs a signal, which is, for example, a high-level signal, indicating that the control calculation section 633 is abnormal to the control calculation section 633. When the control calculation section 633 receives the high-level signal from the monitoring IC, the control calculation section 633 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S185.

In step S130 subsequent to step S120, the control calculation section 633 drives the first actuator 10. Specifically, the control calculation section 633 outputs the signal for driving the first actuator 10 to the first drive circuit 71. The first drive circuit 71 drives the first actuator motor 13 based on the signal from the control calculation section 633. The first actuator motor 13 rotates based on the signal from the first drive circuit 71 to drive the first pump 12. With this driving, the first pump 12 increases the pressure of the brake fluid from the reservoir 11. The brake fluid with the increased hydraulic pressure flows from the first actuator 10 to the second actuator 20.

Subsequently, in step S140, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the first drive circuit 71 is normal. Specifically, the control calculation section 633 obtains a first hydraulic pressure P1 from the first pressure sensor 14 through the communication section 631. The first hydraulic pressure P1 is the hydraulic pressure of the brake fluid having flowed from the first actuator 10 to the second actuator 20 in step S130. Then, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the first hydraulic pressure P1 is equal to or higher than a first hydraulic pressure threshold P1\_th. When the first hydraulic pressure P1 is equal to or higher than the first hydraulic pressure threshold P1\_th, the first actuator 10 is driven normally by the first drive circuit 71. Thus, the first drive circuit 71 is normal. Therefore, at this time, the processing proceeds to step S150. When the first hydraulic pressure P1 is lower than the first hydraulic pressure threshold P1\_th, the first actuator 10 is not driven normally by the first drive circuit 71. Thus, the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal. Therefore, at this time, the processing proceeds to step S185. The first hydraulic pressure threshold P1\_th is set through experiments, simulations, or the like. Alternatively, when the first hydraulic pressure P1 is lower than the first hydraulic pressure threshold P1\_th, the first actuator 10 may be determined to be abnormal.

In step S150 subsequent to step S140, the control calculation section 633 drives the second actuator 20. Specifically, the control calculation section 633 outputs the signal for driving the second actuator 20 to the second drive circuit 72. The second drive circuit 72 drives the second actuator motor 30 based on the signal from the control calculation

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section 633. The second actuator motor 30 rotates based on the signal from the second drive circuit 72 to drive the second pump 224 and the third pump 274.

At this time, the second pump 224 sucks the brake fluid stored in the first pressure adjustment reservoir 221. The sucked brake fluid flows between the first differential pressure control valve 212 and each of the first pressure increase control valve 215 and the second pressure increase control valve 218 after the brake fluid flows through the first return-flow pipe line 223. As a result, a pressure of the brake fluid flowing between the first differential pressure control valve 212 and each of the first pressure increase control valve 215 and the second pressure increase control valve 218 is increased.

At this time, the third pump 274 sucks a brake fluid stored in the second pressure adjustment reservoir 271. The sucked brake fluid flows between the second differential pressure control valve 262 and each of the third pressure increase control valve 265 and the fourth pressure increase control valve 268 after the brake fluid flows through the second return-flow pipe line 273. As a result, a pressure of the brake fluid flowing between the second differential pressure control valve 262 and each of the third pressure increase control valve 265 and the fourth pressure increase control valve 268 is increased.

Subsequently, in step S160, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the second drive circuit 72 is normal. Specifically, the control calculation section 633 obtains a second hydraulic pressure P2 from the second pressure sensor 213 through the communication section 631. The second hydraulic pressure P2 is the pressure of the brake fluid flowing between the first differential pressure control valve 212 and each of the first pressure increase control valve 215 and the second pressure increase control valve 218 in step S150. The control calculation section 633 also obtains a third hydraulic pressure P3 from the third pressure sensor 263 through the communication section 631. The third hydraulic pressure P3 is the pressure of the brake fluid flowing between the second differential pressure control valve 262 and each of the third pressure increase control valve 265 and the fourth pressure increase control valve 268 in step S150.

Then, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the second hydraulic pressure P2 is equal to or higher than a second hydraulic pressure threshold P2\_th and the third hydraulic pressure P3 is equal to or higher than a third hydraulic pressure threshold P3\_th. When the second hydraulic pressure P2 is equal to or higher than the second hydraulic pressure threshold P2\_th and the third hydraulic pressure P3 is equal to or higher than the third hydraulic pressure threshold P3\_th, the second actuator 20 is driven normally by the second drive circuit 72. Thus, the second drive circuit 72 is normal. Therefore, at this time, the processing proceeds to step S170. When the second hydraulic pressure P2 is lower than the second hydraulic pressure threshold P2\_th or the third hydraulic pressure P3 is lower than the third hydraulic pressure threshold P3\_th, the second actuator 20 is not driven normally by the second drive circuit 72. Thus, the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal. Therefore, at this time, the processing proceeds to step S185. The second hydraulic pressure threshold P2\_th and the third hydraulic pressure threshold P3\_th are set through experiments, simulations, or the like. Alternatively, when the second hydraulic pressure P2 is lower than the second hydraulic pressure threshold P2\_th or the third hydraulic

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pressure P3 is lower than the third hydraulic pressure threshold P3\_th, the second actuator 20 may be determined to be abnormal.

In step S170 subsequent to step S160, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the stroke sensor 86 is normal. Specifically, the control calculation section 633 determines whether the sensor output Vs obtained in step S100 is equal to or higher than a first sensor threshold Vs\_th1 and equal to or lower than a second sensor threshold Vs\_th2. When the sensor output Vs is equal to or higher than the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1 and equal to or lower than the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2, the stroke sensor 86 is normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S180. When the sensor output Vs is lower than the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1, the stroke sensor 86 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S185. When the sensor output Vs is higher than the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2, the stroke sensor 86 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S185. The first sensor threshold Vs\_th1 is set based on, for example, an initial position of the brake pedal 81 and a variation in position of the brake pedal 81. The second sensor threshold Vs\_th2 is set based on, for example, the maximum value of the stroke amount X of the brake pedal 81 and a variation in position of the brake pedal 81.

In step S180, the control calculation section 633 performs normal control of the first actuator 10 based on the sensor output Vs that corresponds to the stroke amount X, obtained in step S100.

For example, as illustrated in FIG. 10, when the pedal portion 811 is pressed by the driver of the vehicle 6, the lever portion 812 rotates about the rotation axis O. With this rotation, the stroke amount X increases, and thus the sensor output Vs increases. At this time, the control calculation section 633 outputs, to the first drive circuit 71, the signal for driving the first actuator 10 to increase the first hydraulic pressure P1 in order to decelerate the vehicle 6. The first drive circuit 71 drives the first actuator motor 13 based on the signal from the control calculation section 633. At this time, a rotation speed of the first actuator motor 13 increases. With this increase in the rotation speed, the first pump 12 increases the pressure of the brake fluid from the reservoir 11. Therefore, the first hydraulic pressure P1 increases. The brake fluid that is relatively high in the first hydraulic pressure P1 flows from the first actuator 10 to the second actuator 20.

When the stroke amount X increases, the elastic member 91 contracts because the elastic member 91 is connected to the inner front side of the housing tubular portion 884 and the lever portion 812. With this contraction, the reaction force Fr is generated along with the restoration force of the elastic member 91. When the driver of the vehicle 6 takes his or her foot off the pedal portion 811, the reaction force Fr causes the brake pedal 81 to return to the initial position. In FIG. 10, the position of the brake pedal 81 in the initial state is indicated by a dashed double-dotted line. Herein, the stroke amount X is the amount of the translational movement of the pedal portion 811 toward the front of the vehicle 6, and thus a direction of the reaction force Fr is a direction toward the rear.

In step S180, the control calculation section 633 performs the normal control, ABS control, VSC control, and the like. The ABS is an abbreviation for Antilock Brake System. The VSC is an abbreviation for Vehicle Stability Control.

For example, when the pedal portion 811 is pressed by the driver of the vehicle 6, the control calculation section 633 performs the normal control, which is brake control made by the driver of the vehicle 6 operating the brake pedal 81. At

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this time, the lever portion 812 rotates about the rotation axis O. With this rotation, the stroke amount X increases, and thus the sensor output Vs increases. At this time, the control calculation section 633 controls the second drive circuit 72 in order to decelerate the vehicle 6. With this control, the second drive circuit 72 brings the pressure increase control valves in the second actuator 20 into the communicating state by bringing the solenoid coils of the pressure increase control valves in the second actuator 20 into the non-energized state. Therefore, the brake fluid having flowed from the first actuator 10 to the second actuator 20 flows to each of the left front wheel W/C 2, the right front wheel W/C 3, the left rear wheel W/C 4, and the right rear wheel W/C 5, through each corresponding pressure increase control valve. Thus, each brake pad (not illustrated) comes into frictional contact with the corresponding brake disc. Therefore, each wheel that corresponds to each brake disc is decelerated, and thus the vehicle 6 decelerates. As a result, the vehicle 6 stops.

The control calculation section 633 calculates a slip ratio of each of the left front wheel FL, the right front wheel FR, the left rear wheel RL, and the right rear wheel RR, based on, for example, each of the wheel speeds and the vehicle speed obtained in step S100. Then, the control calculation section 633 determines whether to perform the ABS control based on the slip ratios. When the ABS control is performed, the control calculation section 633 performs any of a pressure reducing mode, a maintaining mode, and a pressure increasing mode in accordance with the slip ratios. In the pressure reducing mode, the pressure increase control valve that corresponds to the control target wheel is brought into the blocking state while the pressure reduction control valve is appropriately brought into the communicating state. Thus, the pressure is reduced in the W/C that corresponds to the control target wheel. In the maintaining mode, the pressure increase control valve and the pressure reduction control valve that correspond to the control target wheel are brought into the blocking states. Thus, the pressure is maintained in the W/C that corresponds to the control target wheel. In the pressure increasing mode, the pressure reduction control valve that corresponds to the control target wheel is brought into the blocking state while the pressure increase control valve is appropriately brought into the communicating state. Thus, the pressure is increased in the W/C that corresponds to the control target wheel. The slip ratio of each wheel of the vehicle 6 is controlled in this manner. Thus, the left front wheel FL, the right front wheel FR, the left rear wheel RL, and the right rear wheel RR are prevented from being locked.

The control calculation section 633 also calculates a skid state of the vehicle 6 based on, for example, the yaw rate, the steering angle, the acceleration, each of the wheel speeds, the vehicle speed, and the like obtained in step S100. Then, the control calculation section 633 determines whether to perform the VSC control based on the skid state of the vehicle 6. When the VSC control is performed, the control calculation section 633 selects a control target wheel that is used for stabilizing turning of the vehicle 6, based on the skid state of the vehicle 6. The control calculation section 633 controls the second drive circuit 72 such that the pressure is increased in the W/C that corresponds to the selected control target wheel. At this time, the second drive circuit 72 drives the pump that corresponds to the control target wheel by driving the second actuator motor 30. With this driving, the pump that corresponds to the control target wheel sucks the brake fluid stored in the pressure adjustment reservoir that corresponds to the control target wheel. This

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sucked brake fluid flows to the W/C that corresponds to the control target wheel after the brake fluid flows through the return-flow pipe line that corresponds to the control target wheel. As a result, the brake hydraulic pressure is increased in the W/C that corresponds to the control target wheel. Thus, the skid of the vehicle 6 is suppressed. Therefore, traveling of the vehicle 6 is stabilized.

In this manner, in step S180, the control calculation section 633 performs the normal control, the ABS control, the VSC control, and the like. Then, the processing returns to step S100. In step S180, in addition to the normal control, the ABS control, and the VSC control as described above, the control calculation section 633 may perform collision avoidance control, regeneration cooperative control, and the like based on signals from another ECU (not illustrated).

In step S185, when the control calculation section 633 itself is abnormal, the control calculation section 633 outputs a signal indicating that the control calculation section 633 is abnormal to a notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the control calculation section 633 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal, the control calculation section 633 outputs a signal indicating that the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal, the control calculation section 633 outputs a signal indicating that the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the stroke sensor 86 is abnormal, the control calculation section 633 outputs a signal indicating that the stroke sensor 86 is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the stroke sensor 86 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like. After step S185, the processing proceeds to step S190.

In step S190, when the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 are abnormal, the control calculation section 633 cannot control the first drive circuit 71 and the second drive circuit 72 normally. When the control calculation section 633 itself is abnormal, the control calculation section 633 cannot control the first drive circuit 71 and the second drive circuit 72 normally. Therefore, the vehicle 6 is controlled to decelerate and stop in order to ensure safety of the vehicle 6 by another calculation section or the like that is different from the control calculation section 633. For example, in these cases, a regenerative brake (not illustrated), a parking brake (not illustrated), and the like are controlled by another ECU that is different from the ECU 53. As a result, the vehicle 6 safely decelerates and stops.

When the first power supply 401, the second power supply 402, and the control calculation section 633 are normal, even if one of the first drive circuit 71 or the second drive circuit 72 fails, the control calculation section 633 can control the normal one. Thus, the control calculation section

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633 controls either the first drive circuit 71 or second drive circuit 72, which is normal, to cause the vehicle 6 to decelerate and stop.

For example, when the first power supply 401, the second power supply 402, the control calculation section 633, and the first drive circuit 71 are normal while the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal, the control calculation section 633 causes the vehicle 6 to decelerate and stop. Specifically, the control calculation section 633 outputs the signal for driving the first actuator 10 to the first drive circuit 71. The first drive circuit 71 drives the first actuator motor 13 based on the signal from the control calculation section 633. The first actuator motor 13 rotates based on the signal from the first drive circuit 71 to drive the first pump 12. The first pump 12 increases the pressure of the brake fluid from the reservoir 11. The brake fluid with the increased hydraulic pressure flows to the second actuator 20. The brake fluid having flowed to the second actuator 20 flows to each of the left front wheel W/C 2, the right front wheel W/C 3, the left rear wheel W/C 4, and the right rear wheel W/C 5, through each corresponding pressure increase control valve. With this flow, each brake pad (not illustrated) comes into frictional contact with the corresponding brake disc. Therefore, each wheel that corresponds to each brake disc is decelerated, and thus the vehicle 6 decelerates. As a result, the vehicle 6 stops.

For example, when the first power supply 401, the second power supply 402, the control calculation section 633, and the second drive circuit 72 are normal while the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal, the control calculation section 633 causes the vehicle 6 to decelerate and stop. Specifically, the control calculation section 633 outputs the signal for driving the second actuator 20 to the second drive circuit 72. The second drive circuit 72 drives the second actuator motor 30 based on the signal from the second control calculation section 623. The second actuator motor 30 rotates based on the signal from the second drive circuit 72 to drive the second pump 224 and the third pump 274.

At this time, the second pump 224 sucks the brake fluid stored in the first pressure adjustment reservoir 221. The sucked brake fluid flows between the first differential pressure control valve 212 and each of the first pressure increase control valve 215 and the second pressure increase control valve 218 after the brake fluid flows through the first return-flow pipe line 223. The brake fluid caused to flow by the second pump 224 flows to the left front wheel W/C 2 through the first pressure increase control valve 215. The brake fluid caused to flow by the second pump 224 flows to the right front wheel W/C 3 through the second pressure increase control valve 218.

At this time, the third pump 274 sucks the brake fluid stored in the second pressure adjustment reservoir 271. The sucked brake fluid flows between the second differential pressure control valve 262 and each of the third pressure increase control valve 265 and the fourth pressure increase control valve 268 after the brake fluid flows through the second return-flow pipe line 273. The brake fluid caused to flow by the third pump 274 flows to the right rear wheel W/C 5 through the third pressure increase control valve 265. The brake fluid caused to flow by the third pump 274 flows to the left rear wheel W/C 4 through the fourth pressure increase control valve 268.

Thus, each brake pad (not illustrated) comes into frictional contact with the corresponding brake disc. Therefore, each wheel that corresponds to each brake disc is decelerated.



ated, and thus the vehicle 6 decelerates. As a result, the vehicle 6 stops. After step S190, the processing returns to step S100.

In this manner, the processing of the control calculation section 633 is executed.

In the vehicle brake system 1, the brake of the vehicle 6 is controlled as described above. In the vehicle brake system 1, redundancy is improved. Hereinafter, the improvement of the redundancy will be described. Herein, the redundancy refers to safety, which is obtained by the vehicle brake system 1 provided with backup devices in preparation for a case where any fault occurs in the vehicle brake system 1.

In the present embodiment, the ECU 53 includes the first drive circuit 71 and the second drive circuit 72. The first drive circuit 71 drives the first actuator 10. The second drive circuit 72 drives the second actuator 20. With this configuration, even if one of the first drive circuit 71 or the second drive circuit 72 fails, the vehicle brake system 1 can cause the vehicle 6 to decelerate and stop safely by using the other normal one. Therefore, the redundancy of the vehicle brake system 1 can be ensured, and thus the redundancy of the vehicle brake system 1 is improved.

The vehicle brake system 1 also has effects as described below.

[1] The vehicle brake system 1 includes the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402. With this configuration, even if one of the first power supply 401 or the second power supply 402 fails, power can be ensured by using the other normal one. Thus, the vehicle brake system 1 can cause the vehicle 6 to decelerate and stop safely. Therefore, the redundancy of the vehicle brake system 1 can be ensured, and thus the redundancy of the vehicle brake system 1 is improved.

[2] The vehicle brake system 1 includes the first actuator 10 and the second actuator 20. With this configuration, even if one of the first actuator 10 or the second actuator 20 fails, the vehicle brake system 1 can cause the vehicle 6 to decelerate and stop safely by using the other normal one. Therefore, the redundancy of the vehicle brake system 1 can be ensured, and thus the redundancy of the vehicle brake system 1 is improved.

#### Second Embodiment

In a second embodiment, the ECU 53 of the vehicle brake system 1 includes two microcomputers. The vehicle brake system 1 further includes two voltage sensors. The vehicle brake device 80 includes two stroke sensors. Processing executed by the ECU 53 is different. The others are similar to those of the first embodiment.

As illustrated in FIG. 11, the ECU 53 of the vehicle brake system 1 according to the second embodiment includes a first microcomputer 61 and a second microcomputer 62, in addition to the first drive circuit 71 and the second drive circuit 72 described above.

The first microcomputer 61 corresponds to a first hydraulic pressure control unit, and controls the first actuator 10 by controlling the first drive circuit 71. Specifically, the first microcomputer 61 includes a first communication section 611, a first storage section 612, and a first control calculation section 613.

The first communication section 611 includes an interface for communicating with the first pressure sensor 14. The first communication section 611 also includes an interface for communicating with the first voltage sensor 451 and an interface for communicating with the second voltage sensor 452. The first communication section 611 further includes an

interface for communicating with the second microcomputer 62 described later. The first communication section 611 also includes an interface for communicating with a first stroke sensor 861 described later and an interface for communicating with a second stroke sensor 862 described later.

The first storage section 612 includes non-volatile memories such as a ROM and a flash memory, and a volatile memory such as a RAM. The non-volatile memories and the volatile memory are non-transitory tangible storage media.

The first control calculation section 613 includes a CPU and the like. The first control calculation section 613 outputs a signal for driving the first actuator motor 13 to the first drive circuit 71 by executing a program stored in the ROM of the first storage section 612.

The second microcomputer 62 corresponds to a second hydraulic pressure control unit, and controls the second actuator 20 by controlling the second drive circuit 72. Specifically, the second microcomputer 62 includes a second communication section 621, a second storage section 622, and a second control calculation section 623.

The second communication section 621 includes an interface for communicating with the second pressure sensor 213 and an interface for communicating with the third pressure sensor 263. The second communication section 621 also includes an interface for communicating with the first voltage sensor 451 and an interface for communicating with the second voltage sensor 452. The second communication section 621 further includes an interface for communicating with the first communication section 611 of the first microcomputer 61. The second communication section 621 also includes an interface for communicating with the first stroke sensor 861 described later and an interface for communicating with the second stroke sensor 862 described later.

The second storage section 622 includes non-volatile memories such as a ROM and a flash memory, and a volatile memory such as a RAM. The non-volatile memories and the volatile memory are non-transitory tangible storage media.

The second control calculation section 623 includes a CPU and the like. The second control calculation section 623 outputs a signal for driving the second actuator motor 30 to the second drive circuit 72 by executing a program stored in the ROM of the second storage section 622.

The vehicle brake device 80 includes the brake pedal 81, the housing 88, and the reaction force generation portion 90, which are similar to those of the first embodiment described above. The vehicle brake device 80 also includes a first sensor power supply line 821, a first sensor ground line 831, a first sensor output line 841, and a second sensor output line 842. The vehicle brake device 80 further includes a second sensor power supply line 822, a second sensor ground line 832, a third sensor output line 843, a fourth sensor output line 844, the first stroke sensor 861, and the second stroke sensor 862.

As illustrated in FIGS. 11 and 12, the first sensor power supply line 821 is connected to the ECU 53 and the first stroke sensor 861. With this connection, power from the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 is supplied to the first stroke sensor 861 through the ECU 53.

The first sensor ground line 831 is connected to the ECU 53 and the first stroke sensor 861.

The first sensor output line 841 is connected to the ECU 53 and the first stroke sensor 861.

The second sensor output line 842 is connected to the ECU 53 and the second stroke sensor 862.

The second sensor power supply line 822 is connected to the ECU 53 and the second stroke sensor 862. With this connection, power from the first power supply 401 and the

second power supply **402** is supplied to the second stroke sensor **862** through the ECU **53**.

The second sensor ground line **832** is connected to the ECU **53** and the second stroke sensor **862**.

The third sensor output line **843** is connected to the ECU **53** and the first stroke sensor **861**.

The fourth sensor output line **844** is connected to the ECU **53** and the second stroke sensor **862**.

The first stroke sensor **861** outputs a signal being in accordance with the stroke amount  $X$  of the brake pedal **81** to the first microcomputer **61** through the first sensor output line **841**. The first stroke sensor **861** also outputs the signal being in accordance with the stroke amount  $X$  of the brake pedal **81** to the second microcomputer **62** through the third sensor output line **843**. Herein, as illustrated in FIG. 13, a first sensor output  $Vs1$ , which is the signal from the first stroke sensor **861**, is adjusted to be constant at  $V1$  when the stroke amount  $X$  is smaller than  $X1$ . The first sensor output  $Vs1$  is adjusted to increase as the stroke amount  $X$  increases when the stroke amount  $X$  is equal to or larger than  $X1$  and smaller than  $X2$ . The first sensor output  $Vs1$  is adjusted to be constant at  $V2$ , which is a value higher than  $V1$ , when the stroke amount  $X$  is equal to or larger than  $X2$ . Note that  $V1$  and  $V2$  are set through experiments, simulations, or the like. Herein,  $V1$  is set to a value lower than the first sensor threshold  $Vs\_th1$  described above. Further,  $V2$  is set to a value higher than the second sensor threshold  $Vs\_th2$  described above.

As illustrated in FIGS. 11 and 12, the second stroke sensor **862** outputs a signal being in accordance with the stroke amount  $X$  of the brake pedal **81** to the first microcomputer **61** through the second sensor output line **842**. The second stroke sensor **862** also outputs the signal being in accordance with the stroke amount  $X$  of the brake pedal **81** to the second microcomputer **62** through the fourth sensor output line **844**. Herein, as illustrated in FIG. 13, a second sensor output  $Vs2$ , which is the signal from the second stroke sensor **862**, is adjusted to be constant at  $V2$ , which is the value higher than  $V1$ , when the stroke amount  $X$  is smaller than  $X1$ . The second sensor output  $Vs2$  is adjusted to decrease as the stroke amount  $X$  increases when the stroke amount  $X$  is equal to or larger than  $X1$  and smaller than  $X2$ . The second sensor output  $Vs2$  is adjusted to be constant at  $V1$ , which is the value lower than  $V2$ , when the stroke amount  $X$  is equal to or larger than  $X2$ .

The vehicle brake system **1** according to the second embodiment is configured as described above.

Next, processing of the first control calculation section **613** will be described with reference to a flowchart of FIG. 14. Here, for example, when the ignition of the vehicle **6** is turned on, the first control calculation section **613** executes programs stored in the ROM of the first storage section **612**. As with the above description, in the initial state, the first power supply **401** is set as the power supply source that supplies power to the ECU **53**.

In step **S300**, the first control calculation section **613** obtains various information. Specifically, the first control calculation section **613** obtains the first voltage  $Vb1$ , which is the voltage applied from the first power supply **401** to the ECU **53**, from the first voltage sensor **451** through the first communication section **611**. The first control calculation section **613** also obtains the hydraulic pressure of the brake fluid supplied from the first actuator **10** to the second actuator **20**, from the first pressure sensor **14** through the first communication section **611**. The first control calculation section **613** further obtains the first sensor output  $Vs1$  that corresponds to the stroke amount  $X$  of the brake pedal **81**

from the first stroke sensor **861** through the first sensor output line **841** and the first communication section **611**. The first control calculation section **613** also obtains the second sensor output  $Vs2$  that corresponds to the stroke amount  $X$  of the brake pedal **81** from the second stroke sensor **862** through the second sensor output line **842** and the first communication section **611**.

Subsequently, in step **S310**, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are normal, similarly to step **S110** executed by the control calculation section **633**, which has been described above. When the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are normal, the processing proceeds to step **S320**. When the first power supply **401** or the second power supply **402** is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step **S390**.

In step **S320** subsequent to step **S310**, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the second control calculation section **623** is normal. Specifically, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the first control calculation section **613** has received a signal indicating that the second control calculation section **623** is abnormal, which will be described later, from the second control calculation section **623**. When the second control calculation section **623** is normal, the processing proceeds to step **S330**. When the second control calculation section **623** is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step **S390**.

In step **S330** subsequent to step **S320**, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the first control calculation section **613** itself is normal by using the watchdog signal and the monitoring IC, similarly to step **S120** executed by the control calculation section **633**, which has been described above. When the first control calculation section **613** itself is normal, the processing proceeds to step **S340**. When the first control calculation section **613** itself is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step **S385**.

In step **S340** subsequent to step **S330**, the first control calculation section **613** drives the first actuator **10**, similarly to step **S130** executed by the control calculation section **633**, which has been described above.

Subsequently, in step **S350**, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the first drive circuit **71** is normal based on the first hydraulic pressure  $P1$ , similarly to step **S140** executed by the control calculation section **633**, which has been described above. When the first drive circuit **71** is normal, the processing proceeds to step **S355**. When the first drive circuit **71** is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step **S385**. As described above, the first hydraulic pressure  $P1$  is the hydraulic pressure of the brake fluid having flowed from the first actuator **10** to the second actuator **20**.

In step **S355** subsequent to step **S350**, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the first sensor power supply line **821** and the second sensor power supply line **822** are normal. Specifically, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether each of the first sensor output  $Vs1$  and the second sensor output  $Vs2$  obtained in step **S300** is equal to or higher than  $V1$  and equal to or lower than  $V2$ . As described above,  $V1$  and  $V2$  are set through experiments, simulations, or the like. Herein, as will be described later,  $V1$  is set to a value lower than the first sensor threshold  $Vs\_th1$  described above. Further,  $V2$  is set to a value higher than the second sensor threshold  $Vs\_th2$  described above.

When the first sensor output  $Vs1$  is equal to or higher than  $V1$  and equal to or lower than  $V2$ , the first sensor power supply line **821** is normal. When the second sensor output  $Vs2$  is equal to or higher than  $V1$  and equal to or lower than

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V2, the second sensor power supply line 822 is normal. Therefore, when each of the first sensor output Vs1 and the second sensor output Vs2 is equal to or higher than V1 and equal to or lower than V2, the first sensor power supply line 821 and the second sensor power supply line 822 are normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S360. When the first sensor output Vs1 or the second sensor output Vs2 is lower than V1, the first sensor power supply line 821 or the second sensor power supply line 822 is abnormal. In this case, for example, disconnection is made. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S385. When the first sensor output Vs1 or the second sensor output Vs2 is higher than V2, the first sensor power supply line 821 or the second sensor power supply line 822 is abnormal. In this case, for example, disconnection is made. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S385.

In step S360 subsequent to step S355, the first control calculation section 613 determines whether the first stroke sensor 861 is normal. Specifically, the first control calculation section 613 determines whether the first sensor output Vs1 obtained in step S300 is equal to or higher than the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1 and equal to or lower than the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2. As described above, the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1 is set based on, for example, the initial position of the brake pedal 81 and the variation in position of the brake pedal 81. The second sensor threshold Vs\_th2 is set based on, for example, the maximum value of the stroke amount X of the brake pedal 81 and the variation in position of the brake pedal 81. Herein, when the stroke amount X is a value near X1 and is larger than X1, that is, when  $X > X1$ , the brake pedal 81 is placed at the initial position. When the stroke amount X is a value near X2 and smaller than X2, that is, when  $X2 > X$ , the stroke amount X of the brake pedal 81 becomes the maximum value. Therefore, herein, V1, V2, the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1, and the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2 have a relationship of  $V1 < Vs\_th1 < Vs\_th2 < V2$ .

When the first sensor output Vs1 is equal to or higher than the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1 and equal to or lower than the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2, the first stroke sensor 861 is normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S365. When the first sensor output Vs1 is equal to or higher than V1 and lower than the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1, the first stroke sensor 861 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S385. When the first sensor output Vs1 is higher than the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2 and equal to or lower than V2, the first stroke sensor 861 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S385. At this time, similarly to the first stroke sensor 861, the first control calculation section 613 may determine whether the second stroke sensor 862 is normal based on the second sensor output Vs2 obtained in step S300.

In step S365 subsequent to step S360, the first control calculation section 613 determines whether the first stroke sensor 861 and the second stroke sensor 862 are normal. Specifically, the first control calculation section 613 calculates a sensor output difference Vs1-Vs2, which is a relative value of a difference between the first sensor output Vs1 and the second sensor output Vs2, based on the first sensor output Vs1 and the second sensor output Vs2 obtained in step S300.

As described above, the first sensor output Vs1 is adjusted to be constant at V1 when the stroke amount X is smaller than X1, as illustrated in FIG. 13. The first sensor output Vs1 is adjusted to increase as the stroke amount X increases when the stroke amount X is equal to or larger than X1 and smaller than X2. The first sensor output Vs1 is constant at V2 when the stroke amount X is equal to or larger than X2.

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The second sensor output Vs2 is adjusted to be constant at V2, which is the value higher than V1, when the stroke amount X is smaller than X1. The second sensor output Vs2 is adjusted to decrease as the stroke amount X increases when the stroke amount X is equal to or larger than X1 and smaller than X2. The second sensor output Vs2 is adjusted to be constant at V1, which is the value lower than V2, when the stroke amount X is equal to or larger than X2. Thus, when the first sensor output Vs1 and the second sensor output Vs2 are normal, the sensor output difference Vs1-Vs2 is a value defined by the stroke amount X.

Therefore, the first control calculation section 613 determines whether the calculated sensor output difference Vs1-Vs2 is within the range of the defined value described above. When the sensor output difference Vs1-Vs2 is within the range of the defined value described above, the first sensor output Vs1 and the second sensor output Vs2 are normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S370. When the sensor output difference Vs1-Vs2 is outside the range of the defined value described above, the first sensor output Vs1 or the second sensor output Vs2 is abnormal. At this time, the first control calculation section 613 determines which of the first stroke sensor 861 or the second stroke sensor 862 is abnormal. Then, the processing proceeds to step S385.

In step S370 subsequent to step S365, the first control calculation section 613 determines whether the second drive circuit 72 is normal. Specifically, the first control calculation section 613 determines whether the first control calculation section 613 has received a signal indicating that the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal, which will be described later, from the second control calculation section 623. When the second drive circuit 72 is normal, the processing proceeds to step S380. When the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step S390.

In step S380 subsequent to step S370, the first control calculation section 613 controls the first actuator 10, similarly to step S180 executed by the control calculation section 633, which has been described above. Specifically, the first control calculation section 613 performs the normal control of the first actuator 10 based on the first sensor output Vs1 that corresponds to the stroke amount X and that has been obtained in step S300. At this time, the first control calculation section 613 may perform the normal control of the first actuator 10 based on the second sensor output Vs2 that corresponds to the stroke amount X and that has been obtained in step S300. Then, the processing returns to step S300.

In step S385, when the first control calculation section 613 itself is abnormal, the first control calculation section 613 outputs a signal indicating that the first control calculation section 613 is abnormal to the second control calculation section 623. At this time, the first control calculation section 613 also outputs the signal indicating that the first control calculation section 613 is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the first control calculation section 613 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal, the first control calculation section 613 outputs a signal indicating that the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal to the second control calculation section 623. At this time, the first control calculation section 613 outputs the signal indicating that the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the

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vehicle 6 that the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the first sensor power supply line 821 is abnormal, the first control calculation section 613 outputs a signal indicating that the first sensor power supply line 821 is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the first sensor power supply line 821 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the second sensor power supply line 822 is abnormal, the first control calculation section 613 outputs a signal indicating that the second sensor power supply line 822 is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the second sensor power supply line 822 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the first stroke sensor 861 is abnormal, the first control calculation section 613 outputs a signal indicating that the first stroke sensor 861 is abnormal to the notification device. When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the first stroke sensor 861 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the second stroke sensor 862 is abnormal, the first control calculation section 613 outputs a signal indicating that the second stroke sensor 862 is abnormal to the notification device. When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the second stroke sensor 862 is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like. After step S385, the processing proceeds to step S390.

Subsequently, in step S390, when the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 are abnormal, when the first control calculation section 613 itself is abnormal, or when the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal, the first control calculation section 613 cannot control the first drive circuit 71 normally. Therefore, the vehicle 6 is controlled to decelerate and stop in order to ensure the safety of the vehicle 6 by another calculation section or the like that is different from the first control calculation section 613.

For example, in these cases, when the second control calculation section 623 and the second drive circuit 72 are normal, the second control calculation section 623 controls the second actuator 20 by controlling the second drive circuit 72, as described later. As a result, the vehicle 6 safely decelerates and stops.

In these cases, when the second control calculation section 623 and the second drive circuit 72 are abnormal, the regenerative brake (not illustrated), the parking brake (not illustrated), and the like are controlled by another ECU that is different from the ECU 53. As a result, the vehicle 6 safely decelerates and stops.

For example, when the first power supply 401, the second power supply 402, the first control calculation section 613, and the first drive circuit 71 are normal while the second control calculation section 623 or the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal, the first control calculation section 613 causes the vehicle 6 to decelerate and stop.

Specifically, the first control calculation section 613 outputs the signal for driving the first actuator 10 to the first drive circuit 71. The first drive circuit 71 drives the first actuator motor 13 based on the signal from the first control calculation section 613. The first actuator motor 13 rotates based on the signal from the first drive circuit 71 to drive the first pump 12.

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At this time, the first pump 12 increases the pressure of the brake fluid from the reservoir 11. The brake fluid with the increased hydraulic pressure flows to the second actuator 20. The brake fluid having flowed to the second actuator 20 flows to each of the left front wheel W/C 2, the right front wheel W/C 3, the left rear wheel W/C 4, and the right rear wheel W/C 5, through each corresponding pressure increase control valve. With this flow, each brake pad (not illustrated) comes into frictional contact with the corresponding brake disc. Therefore, each wheel that corresponds to each brake disc is decelerated, and thus the vehicle 6 decelerates. As a result, the vehicle 6 stops. After step S390, the processing returns to step S300.

In this manner, the processing of the first control calculation section 613 is executed.

Next, processing of the second control calculation section 623 will be described with reference to a flowchart of FIG. 15. Here, for example, when the ignition of the vehicle 6 is turned on, the second control calculation section 623 executes programs stored in the ROM of the second storage section 622. As with the above description, in the initial state, the first power supply 401 is set as the power supply source that supplies power to the ECU 53.

In step S400, the second control calculation section 623 obtains various information. Specifically, the second control calculation section 623 obtains the first voltage Vb1, which is the voltage applied from the first power supply 401 to the ECU 53, from the first voltage sensor 451 through the second communication section 621. The second control calculation section 623 also obtains the brake hydraulic pressure on the downstream side of the first differential pressure control valve 212 from the second pressure sensor 213 through the second communication section 621. The second control calculation section 623 further obtains the brake hydraulic pressure on the downstream side of the second differential pressure control valve 262 from the third pressure sensor 263 through the second communication section 621. The second control calculation section 623 also obtains the first sensor output Vs1 that corresponds to the stroke amount X of the brake pedal 81 from the first stroke sensor 861 through the third sensor output line 843 and the second communication section 621. The second control calculation section 623 further obtains the second sensor output Vs2 that corresponds to the stroke amount X of the brake pedal 81 from the second stroke sensor 862 through the fourth sensor output line 844 and the second communication section 621. Similarly to step S100 executed by the control calculation section 633, the second control calculation section 623 obtains the yaw rate, the acceleration, the steering angle, each of the wheel speeds, and the vehicle speed from each sensor (not illustrated) through the second communication section 621.

Subsequently, in step S410, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 are normal, similarly to step S110 executed by the control calculation section 633 and step S310 executed by the first control calculation section 613, which have been described above. When the first power supply 401 and the second power supply 402 are normal, the processing proceeds to step S420. When the first power supply 401 or the second power supply 402 is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step S490.

In step S420 subsequent to step S410, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the first control calculation section 613 is normal. Specifically, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the second control calculation section 623 has received, from the

first control calculation section 613, the signal indicating that the first control calculation section 613 is abnormal, output by the first control calculation section 613 in step S385, which has been described above. When the first control calculation section 613 is normal, the processing proceeds to step S430. When the first control calculation section 613 is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step S490.

In step S430 subsequent to step S420, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the second control calculation section 623 itself is normal, similarly to step S120 executed by the control calculation section 633 and step S330 executed by the first control calculation section 613, which have been described above. Specifically, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the second control calculation section 623 itself is normal by using the watchdog signal and the monitoring IC. When the second control calculation section 623 itself is normal, the processing proceeds to step S440. When the second control calculation section 623 itself is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step S485.

In step S440 subsequent to step S430, the second control calculation section 623 drives the second actuator 20, similarly to step S150 executed by the control calculation section 633, which has been described above.

Subsequently, in step S450, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the second drive circuit 72 is normal based on the second hydraulic pressure P2 and the third hydraulic pressure P3, similarly to step S160 executed by the control calculation section 633, which has been described above. When the second drive circuit 72 is normal, the processing proceeds to step S455. When the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step S485. As described above, the second hydraulic pressure P2 is the pressure of the brake fluid flowing between the first differential pressure control valve 212 and each of the first pressure increase control valve 215 and the second pressure increase control valve 218. As described above, the third hydraulic pressure P3 is the pressure of the brake fluid flowing between the second differential pressure control valve 262 and each of the third pressure increase control valve 265 and the fourth pressure increase control valve 268.

In step S455 subsequent to step S450, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the first sensor power supply line 821 and the second sensor power supply line 822 are normal, similarly to step S355 executed by the first control calculation section 613, which has been described above. Specifically, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the first sensor power supply line 821 and the second sensor power supply line 822 are normal based on the first sensor output Vs1 and the second sensor output Vs2 obtained in step S400. When the first sensor power supply line 821 and the second sensor power supply line 822 are normal, the processing proceeds to step S460. When the first sensor power supply line 821 or the second sensor power supply line 822 is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step S485.

In step S460 subsequent to step S455, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the first stroke sensor 861 is normal, similarly to step S360 executed by the first control calculation section 613, which has been described above. Specifically, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the first sensor output Vs1 obtained in step S400 is equal to or higher than the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1 and equal to or lower than the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2. When the first sensor output Vs1 is equal to or higher than the first sensor

threshold Vs\_th1 and equal to or lower than the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2, the first stroke sensor 861 is normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S465. When the first sensor output Vs1 is lower than the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1, the first stroke sensor 861 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S485. When the first sensor output Vs1 is higher than the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2, the first stroke sensor 861 is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step S485. At this time, similarly to the first stroke sensor 861, the second control calculation section 623 may determine whether the second stroke sensor 862 is normal based on the second sensor output Vs2 obtained in step S400.

In step S465 subsequent to step S460, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the first stroke sensor 861 and the second stroke sensor 862 are normal, similarly to step S365 executed by the first control calculation section 613, which has been described above. Specifically, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the first stroke sensor 861 and the second stroke sensor 862 are normal based on the sensor output difference Vs1-Vs2. When the first stroke sensor 861 and the second stroke sensor 862 are normal, the processing proceeds to step S470. When the first stroke sensor 861 or the second stroke sensor 862 is abnormal, the second control calculation section 623 determines which of the first stroke sensor 861 or the second stroke sensor 862 is abnormal. Then, the processing proceeds to step S485.

In step S470 subsequent to step S465, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the first drive circuit 71 is normal. Specifically, the second control calculation section 623 determines whether the second control calculation section 623 has received the signal indicating that the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal, output by the first control calculation section 613 in step S385, which has been described above. When the first drive circuit 71 is normal, the processing proceeds to step S480. When the first drive circuit 71 is abnormal, the processing proceeds to step S490.

In step S480 subsequent to step S470, the second control calculation section 623 controls the second actuator 20, similarly to step S180 executed by the control calculation section 633, which has been described above. Specifically, the second control calculation section 623 performs the normal control, the ABS control, the VSC control, and the like. Then, the processing returns to step S400.

In step S485, when the second control calculation section 623 itself is abnormal, the second control calculation section 623 outputs the signal indicating that the second control calculation section 623 is abnormal to the first control calculation section 613. At this time, the second control calculation section 623 outputs the signal indicating that the second control calculation section 623 is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the second control calculation section 623 is abnormal.

When the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal, the second control calculation section 623 outputs the signal indicating that the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal to the first control calculation section 613. At this time, the second control calculation section 623 outputs the signal indicating that the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle 6 that the second drive circuit 72 is abnormal.

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When the first sensor power supply line **821** is abnormal, the second control calculation section **623** outputs a signal indicating that the first sensor power supply line **821** is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle **6** that the first sensor power supply line **821** is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the second sensor power supply line **822** is abnormal, the second control calculation section **623** outputs a signal indicating that the second sensor power supply line **822** is abnormal to the notification device (not illustrated). When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle **6** that the second sensor power supply line **822** is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the first stroke sensor **861** is abnormal, the second control calculation section **623** outputs a signal indicating that the first stroke sensor **861** is abnormal to the notification device. When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle **6** that the first stroke sensor **861** is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like.

When the second stroke sensor **862** is abnormal, the second control calculation section **623** outputs a signal indicating that the second stroke sensor **862** is abnormal to the notification device. When the notification device has received this signal, the notification device notifies the driver of the vehicle **6** that the second stroke sensor **862** is abnormal through screen display, sound, light, and the like. After step **S485**, the processing proceeds to step **S490**.

Subsequently, in step **S490**, when the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are abnormal, when the second control calculation section **623** itself is abnormal, or when the second drive circuit **72** is abnormal, the second control calculation section **623** cannot control the second drive circuit **72** normally. Therefore, the vehicle **6** is controlled to decelerate and stop in order to ensure the safety of the vehicle **6** by another calculation section or the like that is different from the second control calculation section **623**.

For example, in these cases, when the first control calculation section **613** and the first drive circuit **71** are normal, the first control calculation section **613** controls the first actuator **10** by controlling the first drive circuit **71**, similarly to step **S390** described above. As a result, the vehicle **6** safely decelerates and stops.

In these cases, when the first control calculation section **613** and the first drive circuit **71** are abnormal, the regenerative brake (not illustrated), the parking brake (not illustrated), and the like are controlled by another ECU that is different from the ECU **53**, similarly to step **S390** described above. As a result, the vehicle **6** safely decelerates and stops.

For example, when the first power supply **401**, the second power supply **402**, the second control calculation section **623**, and the second drive circuit **72** are normal while the first control calculation section **613** or the first drive circuit **71** is abnormal, the second control calculation section **623** causes the vehicle **6** to decelerate and stop.

Specifically, the second control calculation section **623** outputs the signal for driving the second actuator **20** to the second drive circuit **72**. The second drive circuit **72** drives the second actuator motor **30** based on the signal from the second control calculation section **623**. The second actuator motor **30** rotates based on the signal from the second drive circuit **72** to drive the second pump **224** and the third pump **274**.

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At this time, the second pump **224** sucks the brake fluid stored in the first pressure adjustment reservoir **221**. The sucked brake fluid flows between the first differential pressure control valve **212** and each of the first pressure increase control valve **215** and the second pressure increase control valve **218** after the brake fluid flows through the first return-flow pipe line **223**. The brake fluid caused to flow by the second pump **224** flows to the left front wheel W/C **2** through the first pressure increase control valve **215**. The brake fluid caused to flow by the second pump **224** flows to the right front wheel W/C **3** through the second pressure increase control valve **218**.

At this time, the third pump **274** sucks the brake fluid stored in the second pressure adjustment reservoir **271**. The sucked brake fluid flows between the second differential pressure control valve **262** and each of the third pressure increase control valve **265** and the fourth pressure increase control valve **268** after the brake fluid flows through the second return-flow pipe line **273**. The brake fluid caused to flow by the third pump **274** flows to the right rear wheel W/C **5** through the third pressure increase control valve **265**. The brake fluid caused to flow by the third pump **274** flows to the left rear wheel W/C **4** through the fourth pressure increase control valve **268**.

Thus, each brake pad (not illustrated) comes into frictional contact with the corresponding brake disc. Therefore, each wheel that corresponds to each brake disc is decelerated, and thus the vehicle **6** decelerates. As a result, the vehicle **6** stops. After step **S490**, the processing returns to step **S400**.

In this manner, the processing of the second control calculation section **623** is executed.

Effects similar to those in the first embodiment are obtained also in the second embodiment. In the second embodiment, the vehicle brake system **1** includes the first microcomputer **61** and the second microcomputer **62**. With this configuration, even if one of the first microcomputer **61** or the second microcomputer **62** fails, the vehicle **6** can be caused to decelerate and stop safely by using the other normal one. Therefore, the redundancy of the vehicle brake system **1** can be ensured, and thus the redundancy of the vehicle brake system **1** is improved.

In the second embodiment, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the first sensor power supply line **821** is normal based on the first sensor output Vs1 of the first stroke sensor **861**, V1, and V2. In addition, the second control calculation section **623** determines whether the second sensor power supply line **822** is normal based on the second sensor output Vs2 of the second stroke sensor **862**, V1, and V2. Further, the first control calculation section **613** and the second control calculation section **623** determine whether the first stroke sensor **861** is normal based on the first sensor output Vs1 of the first stroke sensor **861**, the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1, and the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2. The first control calculation section **613** and the second control calculation section **623** also determine whether the second stroke sensor **862** is normal based on the second sensor output Vs2 of the second stroke sensor **862**, the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1, and the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2. With these determinations, a distinction can be made between the abnormality of the wiring lines and the abnormality of the sensors. As described above, V1, V2, the first sensor threshold Vs\_th1, and the second sensor threshold Vs\_th2 have the relationship of  $V1 < Vs\_th1 < Vs\_th2 < V2$ .

The first control calculation section **613** and the second control calculation section **623** determine whether the first

stroke sensor **861** and the second stroke sensor **862** are normal based on the sensor output difference  $V_{s1}-V_{s2}$ . With this determination, the abnormality of the sensors is more likely to be detected.

The vehicle brake system **1** also includes the first stroke sensor **861** and the second stroke sensor **862**. With this configuration, even if one of the first stroke sensor **861** or the second stroke sensor **862** fails, the vehicle **6** can be caused to decelerate and stop safely by using the other normal one. Therefore, the redundancy of the vehicle brake system **1** can be ensured, and thus the redundancy of the vehicle brake system **1** is improved.

#### Third Embodiment

In a third embodiment, the vehicle brake system **1** does not include the power supply switching circuit **403** while the vehicle brake system **1** includes two ECUs. Wiring lines of the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are different. The others are similar to those of the second embodiment.

In the third embodiment, as illustrated in FIGS. **16** and **17**, the vehicle brake system **1** further includes a first ECU **51** and a second ECU **52**.

The first ECU **51** corresponds to a first hydraulic pressure control device, and controls the first actuator **10** by controlling the first actuator motor **13**. Specifically, the first ECU **51** includes the first microcomputer **61** and the first drive circuit **71** described above.

The second ECU **52** corresponds to a second hydraulic pressure control device, and controls the second actuator **20** by controlling the second actuator motor **30**. Specifically, the second ECU **52** includes the second microcomputer **62** and the second drive circuit **72** described above.

Here, the first power supply **401** supplies power to the first ECU **51**.

The first voltage sensor **451** outputs, to the first ECU **51**, a signal being in accordance with a voltage applied from the first power supply **401** to the first ECU **51**.

The second power supply **402** supplies power to the second ECU **52**.

The second voltage sensor **452** outputs, to the second ECU **52**, a signal being in accordance with a voltage applied from the second power supply **402** to the second ECU **52**.

The vehicle brake system **1** according to the third embodiment is configured as described above.

In the third embodiment, in step **S310** executed by the first control calculation section **613**, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the first power supply **401** is normal. Specifically, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the first voltage  $V_{b1}$  obtained in step **S300** is equal to or higher than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$  and equal to or lower than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ . When the first voltage  $V_{b1}$  is equal to or higher than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$  and equal to or lower than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ , the first power supply **401** is normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step **S320**. When the first voltage  $V_{b1}$  is lower than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$ , the first power supply **401** is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step **S390**. When the first voltage  $V_{b1}$  is higher than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ , the first power supply **401** is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step **S390**. The other processing is similar to that described above.

In step **S410** executed by the second control calculation section **623**, the second control calculation section **623** determines whether the second power supply **402** is normal.

Specifically, the second control calculation section **623** determines whether the second voltage  $V_{b2}$  obtained in step **S400** is equal to or higher than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$  and equal to or lower than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ . When the second voltage  $V_{b2}$  is equal to or higher than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$  and equal to or lower than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ , the second power supply **402** is normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step **S420**. When the second voltage  $V_{b2}$  is lower than the first voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th1}$ , the second power supply **402** is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step **S490**. When the second voltage  $V_{b2}$  is higher than the second voltage threshold  $V_{b\_th2}$ , the second power supply **402** is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step **S490**. The other processing is similar to that described above.

Effects similar to those in the second embodiment are obtained also in the third embodiment.

#### Fourth Embodiment

In a fourth embodiment, as illustrated in FIG. **18**, the vehicle brake device **80** further includes a third sensor power supply line **823**, a third sensor ground line **833**, a fourth sensor power supply line **824**, and a fourth sensor ground line **834**. The others are similar to those of the third embodiment.

The third sensor power supply line **823** is connected in a manner similar to the first sensor power supply line **821**, and is connected to the first ECU **51** and the first stroke sensor **861**.

The third sensor ground line **833** is connected in a manner similar to the first sensor ground line **831**, and is connected to the first ECU **51** and the first stroke sensor **861**.

The fourth sensor power supply line **824** is connected in a manner similar to the second sensor power supply line **822**, and is connected to the second ECU **52** and the second stroke sensor **862**.

The fourth sensor ground line **834** is connected in a manner similar to the second sensor ground line **832**, and is connected to the second ECU **52** and the second stroke sensor **862**.

Effects similar to those in the third embodiment are obtained also in the fourth embodiment. In the fourth embodiment, the vehicle brake device **80** further includes the third sensor power supply line **823**, the third sensor ground line **833**, the fourth sensor power supply line **824**, and the fourth sensor ground line **834**. With this configuration, even if any of the wiring lines described above is disconnected, power is supplied to the first stroke sensor **861** and the second stroke sensor **862** through the normal wiring lines. Therefore, the redundancy of the vehicle brake system **1** can be ensured, and thus the redundancy of the vehicle brake system **1** is improved.

#### Fifth Embodiment

In a fifth embodiment, the vehicle brake device **80** does not include the first sensor output line **841**, the second sensor output line **842**, the third sensor output line **843**, and the fourth sensor output line **844**, while the vehicle brake device **80** includes the fifth sensor output line **845** and the sixth sensor output line **846**. The others are similar to those of the third embodiment.

As illustrated in FIGS. **19** and **20**, the fifth sensor output line **845** is connected to the first ECU **51** and the first stroke sensor **861**.

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The sixth sensor output line **846** is connected to the second ECU **52** and the second stroke sensor **862**.

In this case, in step **S300**, the first control calculation section **613** obtains the first sensor output **Vs1** that corresponds to the stroke amount **X** of the brake pedal **81** from the first stroke sensor **861** through the fifth sensor output line **845** and the first communication section **611**. In step **S300**, the first control calculation section **613** also obtains the second sensor output **Vs2** that corresponds to the stroke amount **X** of the brake pedal **81** by wirelessly communicating with the second ECU **52**. The other processing is similar to that described above.

In step **S400**, the second control calculation section **623** obtains the second sensor output **Vs2** that corresponds to the stroke amount **X** of the brake pedal **81** from the second stroke sensor **862** through the sixth sensor output line **846** and the second communication section **621**. In step **S400**, the second control calculation section **623** also obtains the first sensor output **Vs1** that corresponds to the stroke amount **X** of the brake pedal **81** by wirelessly communicating with the first ECU **51**. The other processing is similar to that described above.

Effects similar to those in the third embodiment are obtained also in the fifth embodiment. In the fifth embodiment, the number of wiring lines can be reduced as compared to that in the third embodiment. Thus, weight of the vehicle brake device **80** and cost such as material cost can be reduced.

## Sixth Embodiment

In a sixth embodiment, the vehicle brake system **1** does not include the power supply switching circuit **403**, the first voltage sensor **451**, and the second voltage sensor **452** while the vehicle brake system **1** includes a power distribution unit **404** as illustrated in FIG. **21**. The others are similar to those of the second embodiment.

The power distribution unit **404** receives power supply from the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402**. The power distribution unit **404** includes a power distribution circuit (not illustrated), and receives power supplied from the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402**. The power distribution unit **404** distributes the received power to the first microcomputer **61** and the second microcomputer **62**.

The power distribution unit **404** further includes a microcomputer (not illustrated), a ROM (not illustrated), a voltage sensor (not illustrated), and the like. When the ignition of the vehicle **6** is turned on, the power distribution unit **404** distributes the power supplied from the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** to the first microcomputer **61** and the second microcomputer **62**. At this time, the power distribution unit **404** determines whether the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are normal by executing a program stored in the ROM of the power distribution unit **404**. Hereinafter, the determination of the power distribution unit **404** will be described with reference to a flowchart of FIG. **22**.

In step **S500**, the power distribution unit **404** determines whether the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are normal. Specifically, the voltage sensor (not illustrated) of the power distribution unit **404** measures a voltage applied from the first power supply **401** to the power distribution unit **404**. The voltage sensor (not illustrated) of the power distribution unit **404** also measures a voltage applied from the second power supply **402** to the power distribution unit **404**. Then, the power distribution unit **404**

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determines whether each of these measured voltages is equal to or higher than a first distribution-used voltage threshold and equal to or lower than a second distribution-used voltage threshold. When each of the measured voltages is equal to or higher than the first distribution-used voltage threshold and equal to or lower than the second distribution-used voltage threshold, the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are normal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step **S510**. When one of the measured voltages is lower than the first distribution-used voltage threshold, the first power supply **401** or the second power supply **402** is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step **S520**. When one of the measured voltages is higher than the second distribution-used voltage threshold, the first power supply **401** or the second power supply **402** is abnormal. Thus, the processing proceeds to step **S520**.

In step **S510** subsequent to step **S500**, the power distribution unit **404** transmits a normality signal indicating that the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are normal to the first microcomputer **61** and the second microcomputer **62**. Then, the processing returns to step **S500**.

In step **S520** subsequent to step **S500**, the power distribution unit **404** transmits an abnormality signal indicating that the first power supply **401** or the second power supply **402** is abnormal (for example, the first power supply **401** or the second power supply **402** is disconnected) to the first microcomputer **61** and the second microcomputer **62**. Then, the processing returns to step **S500**.

Then, in step **S310**, the first control calculation section **613** determines whether the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are normal based on the normality signal and the abnormality signal from the power distribution unit **404**. The other processing is similar to that described above.

In step **S410**, the second control calculation section **623** determines whether the first power supply **401** and the second power supply **402** are normal based on the normality signal and the abnormality signal from the power distribution unit **404**. The other processing is similar to that described above.

In this manner, the processing of the power distribution unit **404**, the first control calculation section **613**, and the second control calculation section **623** is executed.

Effects similar to those in the second embodiment are obtained also in the sixth embodiment.

## Seventh Embodiment

In a seventh embodiment, the pressure of the brake fluid from the reservoir **11** is increased without using the first pump **12**. The others are similar to those of the first embodiment.

As illustrated in FIG. **23**, the first actuator **10** includes a gear mechanism **15**, an actuator cylinder **16**, and an actuator piston **17** in addition to the reservoir **11**, the first actuator motor **13**, and the first pressure sensor **14** described above.

The gear mechanism **15** has a ball screw and a rack and pinion. The gear mechanism **15** is connected to the first actuator motor **13**. Thus, the gear mechanism **15** is caused to perform translational movement by rotation of the first actuator motor **13**.

The actuator cylinder **16** is formed in a bottomed cylindrical shape, and is connected to the reservoir **11**. Thus, the brake fluid in the reservoir **11** flows into the actuator cylinder **16** through a hole (not illustrated) of the reservoir **11** and a hole (not illustrated) of the actuator cylinder **16**.



The actuator piston 17 is connected to the gear mechanism 15, and has a plurality of actuator springs 171. With this configuration, when the gear mechanism 15 is caused to translate by the rotation of the first actuator motor 13, the actuator piston 17 is caused to perform translational movement along with the gear mechanism 15. As a result, the actuator piston 17 slides in the actuator cylinder 16 along an axial direction of the actuator cylinder 16. When the actuator piston 17 slides, a pressure of the brake fluid in the actuator cylinder 16 is increased. Simultaneously, another hole (not illustrated) of the actuator cylinder 16, which is connected to the first main pipe line 211 and the second main pipe line 261, is opened. At this time, the brake fluid with the increased hydraulic pressure flows from the other hole (not illustrated) of the actuator cylinder 16 toward the second actuator 20.

When the power supply is stopped from the first drive circuit 71 to the first actuator motor 13, the first actuator motor 13 stops its rotation. When the rotation of the first actuator motor 13 is stopped, the actuator piston 17 is caused to perform the translational movement along with the gear mechanism 15 by a restoration force of the plurality of actuator springs 171. As a result, the actuator piston 17 returns to the initial position.

Effects similar to those in the first embodiment are obtained also in the seventh embodiment.

#### Eighth Embodiment

In an eighth embodiment, as illustrated in FIG. 24, the first power supply 401 supplies power to the first ECU 51 and the second ECU 52. The second power supply 402 supplies power to the first ECU 51 and the second ECU 52. The others are similar to those of the third embodiment.

Effects similar to those in the third embodiment are obtained also in the eighth embodiment.

#### OTHER EMBODIMENTS

The present disclosure is not limited to the above embodiments, and may be appropriately modified from the above embodiments. In the above embodiments, it goes without saying that the constituent elements forming the embodiments are not necessarily indispensable unless otherwise clearly stated or unless otherwise thought to be clearly indispensable in principle.

Each control unit and the like, and each method thereof described in the present disclosure may be implemented by a dedicated computer provided by including a processor and a memory programmed to execute one or more functions embodied by a computer program. Alternatively, each control unit and the like, and each method thereof described in the present disclosure may be implemented by a dedicated computer provided by including a processor with one or more dedicated hardware logic circuits. Alternatively, each control unit and the like, and each method thereof described in the present disclosure may be implemented by one or more dedicated computers configured by a combination of a processor and a memory programmed to execute one or more functions, and a processor with one or more hardware logic circuits. The computer program may be stored in a computer-readable non-transitory tangible storage medium as an instruction to be executed by the computer.

(1) In the above embodiments, the vehicle brake system 1 includes the first power supply 401 and the second power

supply 402. With regard to this configuration, the number of power supplies is not limited to one or two, and may be three or more.

(2) In the above embodiments, the vehicle brake system 1 includes the microcomputer 63. Alternatively, the vehicle brake system 1 includes the first microcomputer 61 and the second microcomputer 62. The number of microcomputers is not limited to one or two, and may be three or more.

(3) In the above embodiments, the vehicle brake system 1 includes the first actuator 10, which corresponds to the first hydraulic pressure generation unit, and the second actuator 20, which corresponds to the second hydraulic pressure generation unit. The number of hydraulic pressure generation units is not limited to two, and may be three or more.

(4) In the above embodiments, the vehicle brake system 1 includes the first drive circuit 71 and the second drive circuit 72. The number of drive circuits is not limited to two, and may be one, or three or more.

(5) In the above embodiments, the vehicle brake device 80 includes the sensor power supply line 82, the sensor ground line 83, the first sensor output line 841, and the second sensor output line 842. The number of wiring lines for each type is not limited to one or two, and may be three or more.

(6) In the above embodiments, the vehicle brake device 80 includes the stroke sensor 86. Alternatively, the vehicle brake device 80 includes the first stroke sensor 861 and the second stroke sensor 862. With regard to these configurations, the number of stroke sensors is not limited to one or two, and may be three or more.

(7) In the above embodiments, the reaction force generation portion 90 of the vehicle brake device 80 includes the elastic member 91. With regard to this configuration, the number of elastic members 91 is not limited to one, and may be two or more.

(8) The first to eighth embodiments may be appropriately combined.

As illustrated in FIG. 25, in addition to the driving of the first actuator 10, the first drive circuit 71 may drive the second actuator 20 by supplying power to the second actuator motor 30 based on a signal from the control calculation section 633. In addition to the driving of the second actuator 20, the second drive circuit 72 may drive the first actuator 10 by supplying power to the first actuator motor 13 based on a signal from the control calculation section 633.

(9) In the above embodiments, the elastic member 91 is the helical compression spring. Unlike this configuration, the elastic member 91 may be a tension spring. In addition, the elastic member 91 may not be limited to an equal pitch spring, and may be a conical spring, an unequal pitch spring, or the like.

What is claimed is:

1. A vehicle brake system comprising:

a vehicle brake device including

a brake pedal that has a pedal portion, and a lever portion rotating about a rotation axis in response to the pedal portion being operated,

a first stroke sensor configured to output a first signal based on a stroke amount of the brake pedal,

a second stroke sensor configured to output a second signal based on the stroke amount of the brake pedal,

a housing that rotatably supports the lever portion, and a reaction force generation portion configured to generate a reaction force applied on the lever portion based on the stroke amount;

a first hydraulic pressure generation unit configured to generate a hydraulic pressure for braking a vehicle;

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- a second hydraulic pressure generation unit configured to generate hydraulic pressure for braking the vehicle;
- a first hydraulic pressure control device that includes a first drive circuit configured to drive the first hydraulic pressure generation unit;
- a second hydraulic pressure control device that includes a second drive circuit configured to drive the second hydraulic pressure generation unit;
- a first power supply configured to supply power to the first hydraulic pressure control device;
- a second power supply configured to supply power to the second hydraulic pressure control device;
- a power supply switching circuit configured to switch a power supply source that supplies the power to the first hydraulic pressure control device and the second hydraulic pressure control device, between the first power supply and the second power supply based on a first voltage that is a voltage applied from the first power supply to the first hydraulic pressure control device and a second voltage that is a voltage applied from the second power supply to the second hydraulic pressure control device;
- a first sensor power supply line that is connected to the first hydraulic pressure control device and the first stroke sensor, and configured to supply the power from the first power supply, from the first hydraulic pressure control device to the first stroke sensor;
- a second sensor power supply line that is connected to the second hydraulic pressure control device and the second stroke sensor, and configured to supply the power from the second power supply, from the second hydraulic pressure control device to the second stroke sensor;
- a third sensor power supply line that is connected to the first hydraulic pressure control device and the first stroke sensor, and configured to supply the power from the first power supply, from the first hydraulic pressure control device to the first stroke sensor;
- a fourth sensor power supply line that is connected to the second hydraulic pressure control device and the second stroke sensor, and configured to supply the power from the second power supply, from the second hydraulic pressure control device to the second stroke sensor;
- a first sensor output line that is connected to the first hydraulic pressure control device and the first stroke sensor, and configured to transmit the first signal from the first stroke sensor to the first hydraulic pressure control device;
- a second sensor output line that is connected to the first hydraulic pressure control device and the second stroke sensor, and configured to transmit the second signal from the second stroke sensor to the first hydraulic pressure control device;

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- a third sensor output line that is connected to the second hydraulic pressure control device and the first stroke sensor, and configured to transmit the first signal from the first stroke sensor to the second hydraulic pressure control device;
  - a fourth sensor output line that is connected to the second hydraulic pressure control device and the second stroke sensor, and configured to transmit the second signal from the second stroke sensor to the second hydraulic pressure control device,
- wherein
- the first hydraulic pressure control device is configured to determine whether the first stroke sensor and the second stroke sensor are normal based on the first signal from the first stroke sensor transmitted through the first sensor output line and the second signal from the second stroke sensor transmitted through the second sensor output line, and when the first stroke sensor and the second stroke sensor are normal, control the first drive circuit based on at least one of the first signal from the first stroke sensor or the second signal from the second stroke sensor to control the hydraulic pressure generated by the first hydraulic pressure generation unit, and
  - the second hydraulic pressure control device is configured to determine whether the first stroke sensor and the second stroke sensor are normal based on the first signal from the first stroke sensor transmitted through the third sensor output line and the second signal from the second stroke sensor transmitted through the fourth sensor output line, and when the first stroke sensor and the second stroke sensor are normal, control the second drive circuit based on at least one of the first signal from the first stroke sensor or the second signal from the second stroke sensor to control the hydraulic pressure generated by the second hydraulic pressure generation unit.
2. The vehicle brake system according to claim 1, wherein the first and second hydraulic pressure control devices includes
- a first hydraulic pressure control unit configured to control the hydraulic pressure generated by the first hydraulic pressure generation unit, by controlling the first drive circuit based on the first signal from the first stroke sensor, and
  - a second hydraulic pressure control unit configured to control the hydraulic pressure generated by the second hydraulic pressure generation unit, by controlling the second drive circuit based on the second signal from the second stroke sensor.

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